



Road Safety Education Pack

Welcome to the EASST Education Pack. This pack is designed to help teach road safety in a variety of formal and informal education settings.

By using the simple, fun, educational activities, teachers and parents can help young people stay safe on the roads.

This pack provides the resources you need to teach children and young people basic road safety principles in an age-appropriate way.

The key principles underlying all the activities in this pack are:

- **Awareness** of traffic and its dangers.
- **Good behaviour** around roads.
- **Making safe choices** to keep you and others safe.

Why Teach Road Safety?

On average more than 500 under 18's die on the world's roads each day. Road crashes are the biggest killer of young people in every world region.

Road safety is vital for children and young people. It is never too early to teach them about basic safety skills. More than 1.2 million people die on the world's roads every year and tens of millions of people are injured or disabled.

Children are particularly at risk because:

- They are smaller so find it harder to see, and be seen by, drivers.
- They are less able to recognise dangerous situations and lack the maturity to make good decisions about safe behaviour.
- They are physically smaller and so are more likely to be hurt by an impact.

Educators can protect children by teaching life-saving messages and skills. Making young people aware of the risks and providing them with strategies to remain safe are important parts of their development.

Road Safety is a great subject for engaging children and young people. Even the youngest child will know something about it, because everyone uses roads and road safety impacts everyone.





Road Safety Education Pack (cont.)

Introducing the Education Pack

This pack provides stimulating and engaging activities to introduce road safety messages and behaviours.

The pack is split into three sections:

- Under 6s
- 6 – 11 year olds
- 12– 14 year olds

The topics in each section vary according to the target age group, but they all relate to our key principles.

How to Use the Education Pack

Each section of the pack provides age-appropriate resources, along with introductory notes and advice for teachers and group leaders.

These background notes and resources give all the information you need to run road safety sessions with young people.

The resources consist of a mixture of teacher-led ACTIVITIES (lesson plans and exercises), as well as HANDOUTS designed to be copied and given to the children.

The activities and handouts form a road safety education programme that can be incorporated into lessons or after-school activities. We suggest having different activities each week over a number of weeks, and reinforcing road safety messages whenever possible.

The activities and handouts can be used individually, too, to raise specific road safety issues. Each one is a stand-alone exercise for improving safety awareness.

When using these resources, please remember the following points:

Key Messages

The Teachers' notes for each section outline the **key messages** for the age group. Each exercise also includes key message and objectives. Try to reinforce these key messages at all times.

Active Learning

Children and young people learn best when active and engaged. Try to make your sessions as **interactive** and hands-on as possible.





Road Safety Education Pack (cont.)

Real Life Experience

It is essential for children and young people to learn about roads, traffic and safe behaviour at first hand. Always try to include **outdoor practical activities** in your road safety teaching.

Understanding the Vocabulary

For children to engage fully and understand road safety, they need to be familiar with the relevant **vocabulary**. Make sure the young people you are working with understand the terms you are using. This is particularly important with young children but remains relevant for all age groups.

Diversity

This pack is designed to focus on universally applicable road safety messages and behaviours to keep children safe. However, the children in your group may have **different experiences** of roads and traffic and you may need to adapt your activities accordingly. For example, some children will come from homes where there is no car, or they might live on a street with no pavement. In addition, children in urban and rural areas will face different issues, and their sessions may require a different emphasis.

Sensitivities

Group leaders should always check whether there is any child in the group with a family member or friend that has been involved in a serious traffic incident. Special sensitivity will need to be shown in these cases, and it may be appropriate to pre-warn the child's parent or carer so they are able to prepare the child for the activities.

Involving Parents / Carers

In addition to teaching the children, it is vital to include and involve parents with your road safety teaching. Children will be influenced by the behaviour of their parents. This pack includes a letter you can give to parents that makes them aware of what the children have learned and how they can reinforce these messages.





UNDER 6s – Introductory Notes

This section of the pack teaches the following key messages:

Traffic is dangerous and can hurt people.

Never go near roads without a grown up and always hold their hand.

Stop, Look and Listen before crossing the road.

Be Bright – so that drivers can see you.

Always wear a seat belt.

Always get in and out of a car safely.

This section introduces basic road safety messages to children under 6 years old. It focuses on awareness of the dangers of traffic, introducing young children to the issues and helping them explore the ideas raised.

It is essential for young children to learn about roads, traffic and safe behaviour at first hand. One of the activities in this section involves taking children outside. Always remember that good planning and close supervision are both vital when taking young children near traffic.

Getting Started

The Under 6s section starts with two activities and a handout to introduce the key issues.

ACTIVITY: ‘Let’s Look at a Car!’ is an outside activity to introduce young children to the dangers of traffic. Before starting the exercise you should have a short group discussion with the children and explain that you will be looking at road safety and the dangers of traffic.

ACTIVITY: ‘Create a Giant Road Map’ is a craft activity to build on the children’s knowledge of traffic dangers. It should teach the children that roads are for traffic and pavements are for pedestrians. This activity may require some pre-planning to ensure you have the resources you need.

HANDOUT: ‘Play Away From Traffic’ is a colouring sheet that can be used to reinforce the learning from the first two activities.





Under 6s – Introductory Notes

Always Hold Hands

The next two exercises teach children always to hold hands with an adult when near a road. This is a simple but essential message. Children under 8 do not have the capacity to judge distance or speed accurately, so it is vital that they understand never to cross a road without an adult.

ACTIVITY: ‘Hand Print Poster’ is a craft activity that gets each child to engage with the message as well as creating a bright fun poster to display and to remind the children of the importance of holding hands.

HANDOUT: ‘Always Hold Hands’ is a colouring activity to reinforce this message.

Stop, Look and Listen

Although children at this age should never cross a road alone, it is not too early to introduce the rules for crossing a road safely. The next few exercises introduce the concept of ‘Stop, look and listen’.

HANDOUT: ‘Stop, Look and Listen’ is an information sheet showing the five stages of crossing the road simply and clearly. It is designed for trainers to use when introducing the concept to children for the first time.

HANDOUT: ‘Crossing the Road’ – This ‘Stop, Look and Listen’ colouring sheet can be used to reinforce the message.

ACTIVITY: The Stop, Look and Listen Action Game is an interactive game to help children remember the key points.

Be Bright

The next two exercises help teach children the importance of bright clothes to ensure they are seen in poor light or weather.

ACTIVITY: ‘Bright is Right’ is a story to read to the children to introduce these issues. The follow up questions will help you to start a structured discussion about being seen.

HANDOUT: ‘Colour Me Bright’ is a colouring activity that reinforces this message.





Under 6s – Introductory Notes

Always Wear a Seat Belt

The next two exercises help teach children the importance of wearing seat belts. Before you start, you should talk to the children about how seat belts protect you and support you safely in the car.

ACTIVITY: ‘Mr Lumpy’s Journey’ is a story to read to the children that explains the importance of wearing a seatbelt. The follow up activities will help you start a structured discussion about the issue.

HANDOUT: ‘Always Wear a Seat Belt’ is a dot-to-dot puzzle that reinforces this message.

Getting in and out of a car safely

ACTIVITY: ‘Getting In and Out of the Car’ is a role-play activity designed to teach children to always get out of the car on the ‘safe’ side - i.e. the side away from the traffic and nearest the pavement. For this you will need to set up chairs to represent a car and use chalk or tape to mark out a pavement. Make sure every child gets a turn – because active learning will reinforce the message more effectively.

HANDOUT: ‘Getting In and Out of the Car Safely’ is a drawing activity designed to reinforce the message following the role play activity.

Remember to reinforce the key messages at all times and make all your sessions as interactive as possible.





ACTIVITY: Let's Look at a Car!¹

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher-led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: Up to 45 minutes - depending on the number of children in the group.

Key Messages: Traffic is dangerous and can hurt people. Never go near roads without a grown up and always hold their hand.

Objective: To introduce young children to the risks of traffic and understand how to stay safe.

For this activity, the group leader will need to park a car in a safe off-road area. The car should be parked away from traffic somewhere where the children can approach it safely. The car should be on a flat surface with the handbrake on and the engine off.

The group leader should explain to the children the importance of standing well away from cars, even when they look like they are not moving.

Take each child up to the side of the car in turn, holding their hand. Ask the children to poke the car and then poke their tummy. Which is soft? Which is hard? Explain that cars are hard and can hurt you if they hit you. You are soft and easily hurt.

Get the children to look at the tyre. Draw their attention to how big and hard it is. Explain that it goes round very fast.

Teach the children that cars and other vehicles are not toys. They are dangerous.

Remind them to stay away from traffic and only go near a road when holding an adult's hand.

¹ This resource was originally published by Brake, the road safety charity, and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. www.brake.org.uk and www.roadsafetyweek.org





ACTIVITY: Create a Giant Road Map²

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: Up to 1 hour.

Key Messages: Traffic is dangerous and can hurt people. Never go near roads without a grown up and always hold their hand.

Objective: This is a creative activity to encourage children to discuss road safety and recognise that roads are for traffic and pavements are for pedestrians.

This activity encourages children to make a giant map of roads and pavements out of coloured paper stuck together.

Either in advance of the activity, or as part of it, create a large background sheet with a clearly marked road and pavement. You could include features from your local area, like a park or school. If not all the roads in your area have pavements, make sure the background sheet reflects your local conditions and talk to the children about how to keep safe. Explain to the children about the importance of keeping to the edge of the road if there is no dedicated pedestrian space.

Help the children cut out pictures of vehicles, people, dogs and buggies out of old magazines. (If you do not have a supply of magazines, you could print pictures from the internet in advance).

Ask the children to glue the pictures in the appropriate places on your giant map. In other words, vehicles on the road, people on the pavement or a suitable safe space away from the traffic, and so on.

Whilst the children are sticking the pictures, talk to them about staying safe around roads using key words and phrases including 'road', 'traffic', 'pavement', 'pedestrian' and 'holding hands'.

When you have finished your giant road map, attach it to a wall as part of a road safety display. At the end of the session, get the children to show the map to their parents / carers.

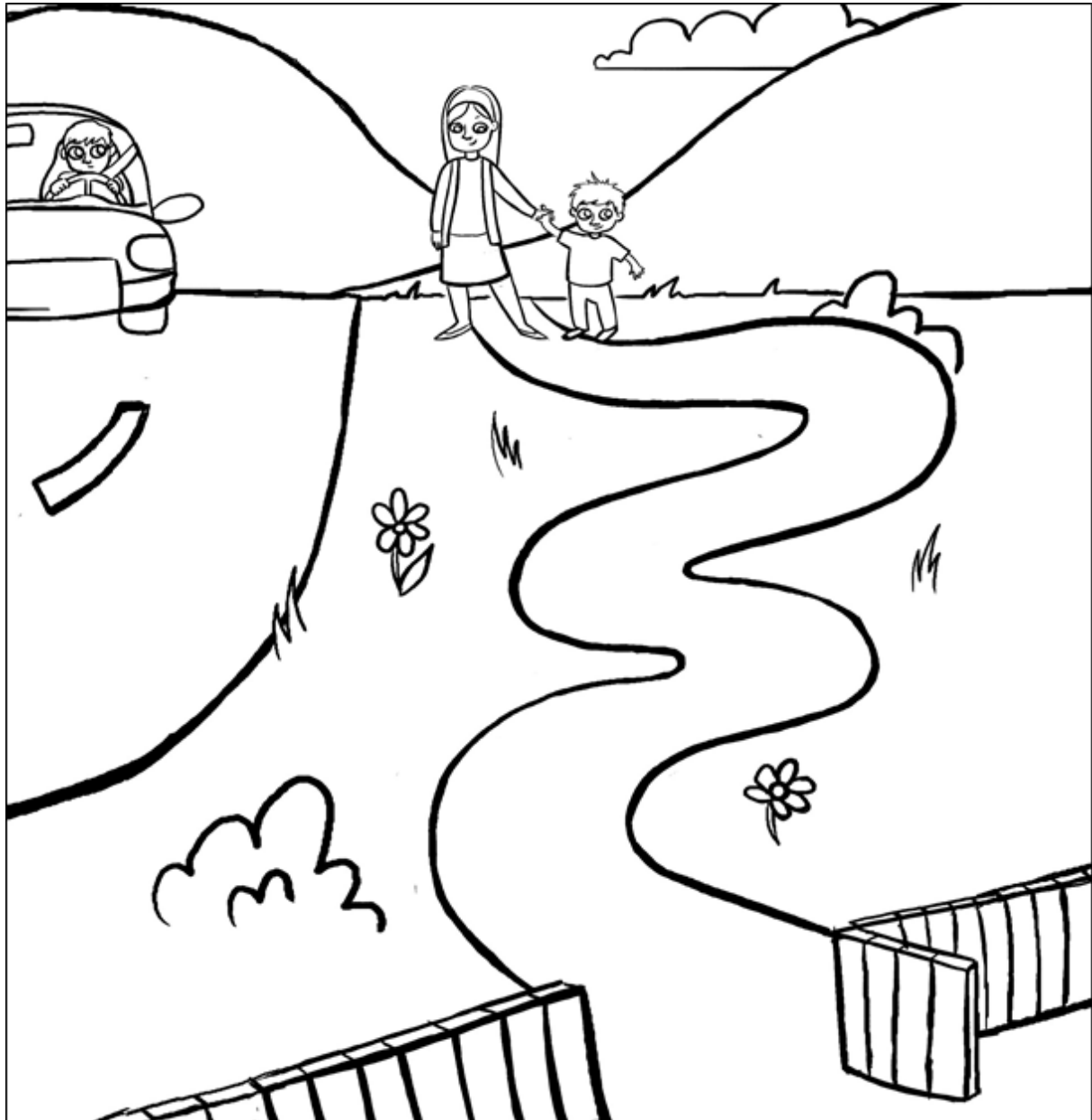
² This resource was originally published by Brake, the road safety charity, and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. www.brake.org.uk and www.roadsafetyweek.org





HANDOUT: Play Away from Traffic Colouring Sheet

Colour the picture below. Remember always play away from traffic.





ACTIVITY: Hand Print Poster

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Messages: Never go near roads without a grown up and always hold their hand.

Objective: To teach the children that they should never cross the road without an adult and that they should always hold an adult's hand near a road.



This is a group activity to produce a large display of the children's hand prints in order to reinforce the importance of holding an adult's hand when near roads or when crossing a road.

Get each child to create a hand print on a piece of paper. They can do this by putting paint on their hand and pressing down on paper to create a print, or by drawing around their hand and then colouring it in.

Help each child to cut out their hand print and arrange all the hand prints on a large sheet of paper to create a poster.

Give the poster a title such as "Going home? Hold hands!" or "Hold Hands and Keep Safe"

If possible, display the poster where both the children and their parents will see it regularly.





HANDOUT: Always Hold Hands

Colour the picture below. Remember always hold hands with an adult when near a road.



11

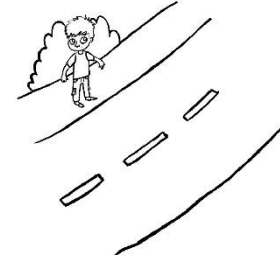




HANDOUT: Stop, Look and Listen

Find the safest place to cross

Find a place where you can see in all directions, and where drivers can see you. Never cross on a bend in the road.



Stop

Stop just before you get to the kerb. Do not get too close to the traffic.

Look

Give yourself lots of time to have a good look around for traffic.

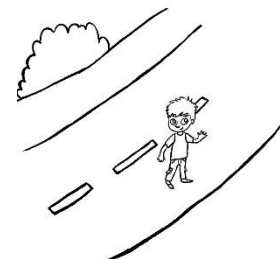


Listen

Listen carefully because you can sometimes hear traffic before you can see it.

When it is safe, cross

Cross only when there is a safe gap and plenty of time. Keep looking and listening while you cross.





HANDOUT: Crossing the Road

Before you cross, always Stop, Look and Listen. Colour the pictures below.

Stop



Look



Listen





ACTIVITY: The Stop, Look and Listen Game

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Message: Stop, Look and Listen before crossing the road.

Objective: To introduce the 'Stop, Look and Listen' message to children.

Talk to the children about the dangers when crossing the road. Explain that before crossing, they should always hold an adult's hand and should 'Stop, Look and Listen' for traffic.

Once they have understood the message you can explain the rules of the 'Stop, Look and Listen' action game.

The Instructions

The children should dance around the room to music. After a few moments, stop the music and call out an action - the children must make the appropriate movement. The aim is not to be the last child. However, there is no penalty for being last.

The actions

Hold hands: Each child must hold hands with the nearest person.

Stop: The children should stand still.

Look: The children should raise their hands to their forehead (as if shielding their eyes from the sun to see better) and look around in all directions.

Listen: The children should be very quiet and cup their hands behind their ears as if listening hard.





ACTIVITY: Story Time: Bright is Right³

Teacher's notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Message: Be Bright – so that drivers can see you

Objective: To read the story to the children and discuss the issues raised in the Follow Up activities.

It was the day before the party at Amy's friend's house.

Amy was excited. 'Dad, can I wear my new black party dress?' asked Amy. 'And can we walk there?'

'Well, now that you are four I think that's OK,' said her dad. 'It is not far. Just down the road'

'Whoopee!' Amy danced about. She loved her new dress.

The next evening was the night of the party. She put on her new black dress and black shoes.

'You look very smart' said dad, smiling. 'But you have to wear your reflective armband.'

He held up two white bands. 'But that will spoil my outfit' said Amy, pulling a face. 'It's not smart.' 'But it will keep you safe,' said Dad. 'It helps drivers to see you at night.'

Dad put on his band and Amy did too, but she wished she could make it disappear. It was very dark outside and cold. Amy was excited, but she held on to her dad's hand.

Amy heard some children laughing up ahead. It was hard to see in the dark but they sounded like her friends, Sam and Peter. Then she saw them. They were dressed in smart trousers and dark coats. Amy called to them and they waited for her on the pavement.

Suddenly, Dad shouted, 'Watch out!'

A car was reversing out of a driveway towards Sam and Peter. Their mum saw it just in time and pulled the boys out of the way.

³ This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





ACTIVITY: Story Time: Bright is Right (Cont.)

The car driver stopped and opened his windows. 'You nearly hit us,' said the boys' mum. She sounded cross.

'I'm really sorry, I just didn't see you,' said the driver. 'You're all wearing black.'

Amy looked at her dad and they all walked very quietly to the party.

The next day was Nursery. Amy got dressed in her brightest clothes and put on her coat with the bright yellow stripe on it.

'You're very colourful,' said Dad when he saw her.

'I want to make sure that drivers can see me when we walk to Nursery,' said Amy.

'Clever girl!' said dad. 'Day or night, bright is right!'



Follow Up Activities

Once you have read the story to the children, discuss the following questions:

- Why was Amy dressed in black?
- Where was she going?
- What happened to Peter and Sam?
- Why did the car nearly hit them?
- Why did Amy wear bright clothes the next day?

Talk to the children about what they are wearing now. Who is wearing bright clothes? Who is wearing dark clothes?

Talk about how bright clothes can help drivers to see you when you are near traffic and how it can keep children safe. Which child would be easiest for drivers to see?

Emphasise that it is sometimes difficult for drivers to see small children even during the day, especially when the weather is bad.





HANDOUT: Colour Me Bright

Colour the children in bright clothes so that they can be seen.



17





ACTIVITY: Story Time - Mr Lumpy's Journey⁴

Teacher's notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key message: Always wear a seat belt.

Objective: To read the story to the children and discuss the issues raised in the Follow Up activities.

'Come on, Jake, we're going to Granny's' said Mum.

'Can Mr Lumpy come too?' said Jake.

Jake reached for an old, battered teddy.

'All right, but be careful with him – he's a very old teddy.' said Mum

Jake cheered. Mr Lumpy was his favourite. Jake climbed onto the back seat of the car.

'Come on,' said Dad, 'I'll strap you in.'

Jake stuck out his lip. 'I don't like the seatbelt'. Dad ignored him and fastened Jake's seat belt.

Jake looked grumpy. Jake put Mr Lumpy on the back seat next to him. 'Silly seat belt' he whispered as they drove along.

Just then, a dog ran out into the road in front of the car. Jake's Mum pressed the brake hard and Jake felt himself jerk forwards suddenly. The car stopped.

'Are you OK, Jake?' said Dad.

Jake was scared. 'I think so.' He felt shaky.

'Thank goodness we didn't hit the dog' said Mum.

'But where is Mr Lumpy?' said Jake. His teddy wasn't on the back seat.

⁴ This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





ACTIVITY: Story Time - Mr Lumpy's Journey (Cont.)

'Here he is' said Dad. 'He was thrown forward when we stopped.'

Dad reached down to pick up Mr Lumpy from next to his feet in the front of the car.

'Oh dear' said Mum.

Jake leaned forwards to see. 'What's the matter?'

Mr Lumpy did not look well. The stitches on his tummy had split open and some of his stuffing had fallen out. Jake nearly started to cry.

'He must have hit the gear stick,' said Mum. 'But don't worry – we'll mend him.'

Jake hugged poor Mr Lumpy. 'I'm glad this didn't happen to me,' he said, feeling his seat belt.

Mum and Dad nodded and they set off slowly. Jake held Mr Lumpy tight.



Follow Up Activities

Talk about the story and discuss the following questions:

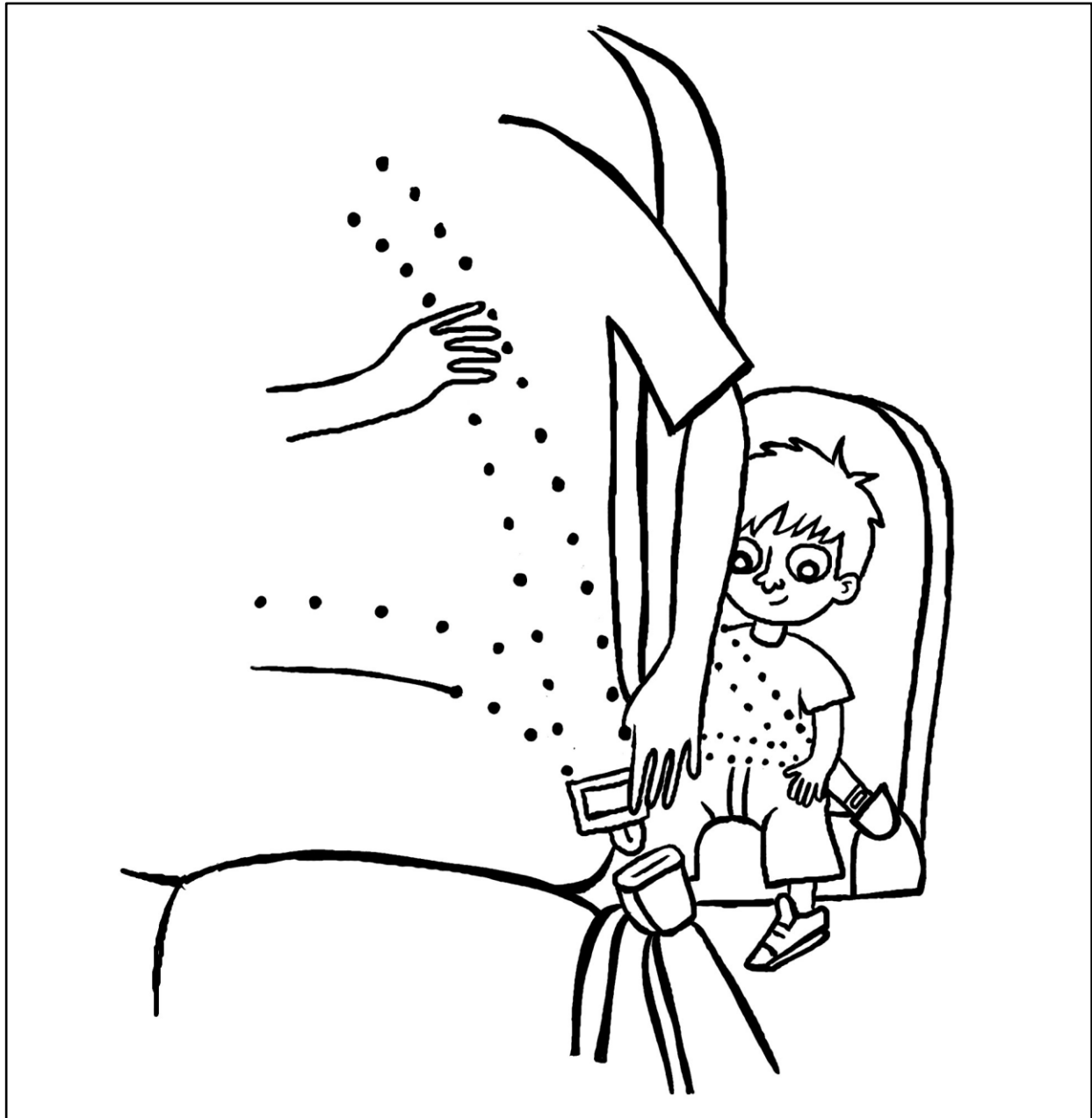
- What happened to Mr Lumpy?
- Why did his stuffing fall out?
- Was Jake hurt when the car stopped suddenly? What kept him safe?
- What can we learn from this story?





HANDOUT: Always Wear a Seat Belt

Join the dots and help the driver and child to put on their seatbelts.



20





ACTIVITY: Getting In and Out of the Car

Teacher's notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 20 minutes.

Key message: Always wear a seat belt.

Objective: This activity teaches children only to get in or out of the car on the pavement side and on the side away from traffic.

Explain to the children about the dangers when getting in and out of a car, and why they must never get out on the road side and only open the door on the side away from the traffic.

Talk to them about their experiences of getting in and out of cars.

Role Play

Use this role play activity to help the children practise getting in and out of a car safely.

Put two chairs side by side and two chairs behind them – as if they were seats in a car. Use tape, chalk or other markers on the floor to mark out the pavement.

Encourage the children to sit in the car, as if they were passengers. Allow the children to practise getting out of the car – ensure that they always leave on the pavement side.

You can also use this exercise to talk about other relevant issues such as:

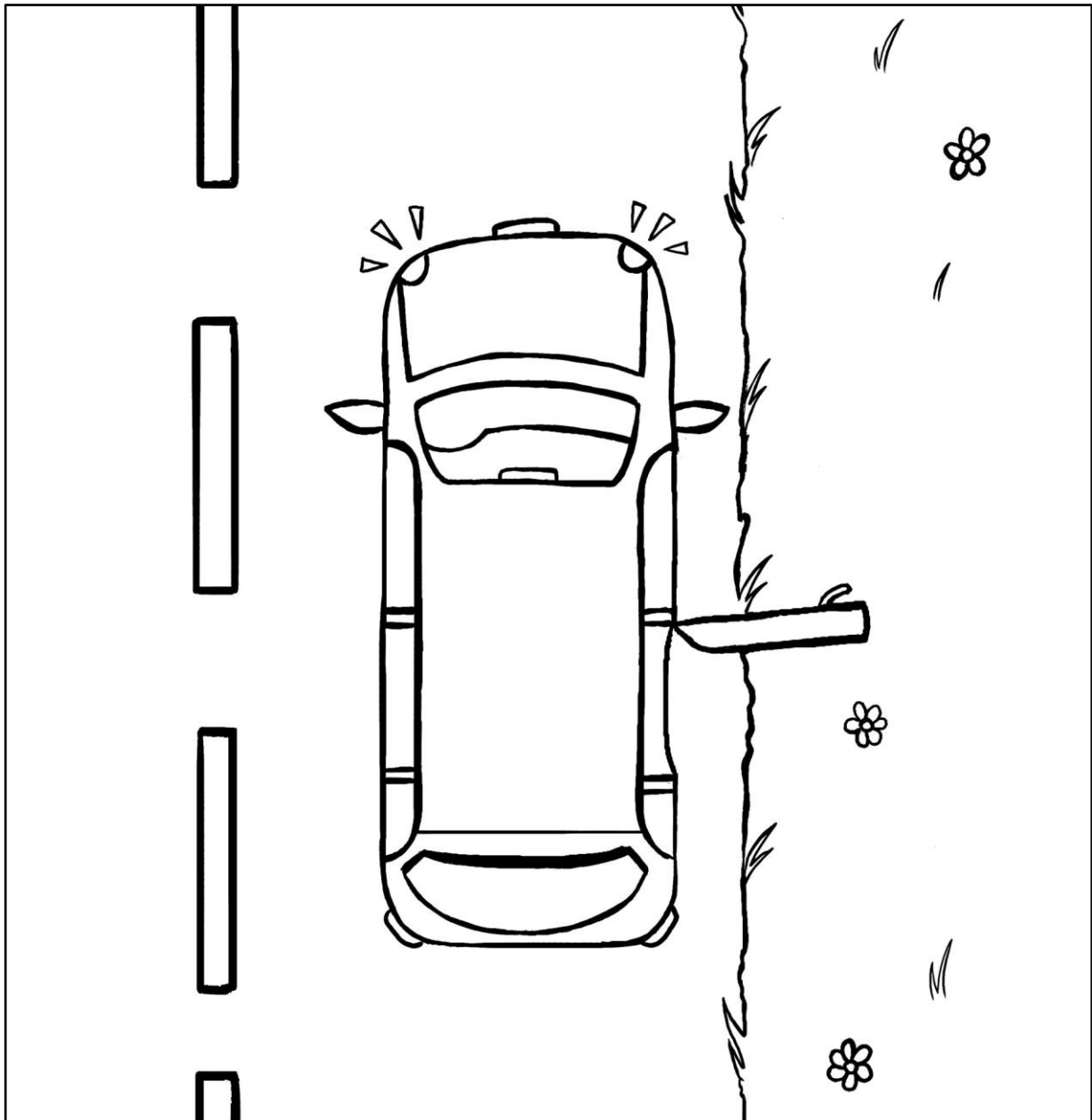
- The importance of wearing seat belts.
- Staying on the pavement.
- Waiting for an adult once out of the car.
- Always holding an adult's hand near the road.
- Wearing bright clothes so that you can be seen by drivers once out of the car.





HANDOUT: Getting In and Out of the Car Safely

Always get out of the car on the safe side, on the side furthest from the traffic. Draw yourself getting out of the car on the safe side.





Dear Parent

Today your child has been learning about road safety as part of a project to reduce the number of road casualties.

The children have been taking part in a range of activities including games, creative tasks, storytelling and practical exercises.

These activities have been teaching them how to keep safe around roads and have focused on the following messages:

Traffic is dangerous and can hurt people.

Never go near roads without a grown up and always hold their hand.

Stop, Look and Listen before crossing the road.

Be Bright – so that drivers can see you.

Always wear a seat belt.

Always get in and out of a car safely – on the side away from the traffic.

Please talk to your child about what they been doing today. I am sure they will be keen to tell you about what they have learned.

Children learn best from practical experience, so you can play a vital role in keeping them safe by talking about these issues whenever you are out and about. Please do emphasise these road safety messages at every opportunity. As a parent you are an important role model for your child.

In addition, setting a good example for young children through your own behaviour on the road and in the car will help them learn good safety skills and apply them throughout their lives. Please keep yourself and your children safe by reinforcing the messages we have been learning today.

Thank you for your support and keep safe!

[Insert name / organisation]





Acknowledgements

The Eastern Alliance of Safe and Sustainable Transport are grateful to the following organisations for supporting the development of this pack.



Brake, The Road Safety Charity
www.brake.org.uk and www.roadsafetyweek.org



European Bank
 for Reconstruction and Development

The European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
www.ebrd.com



FOUNDATION

FIA Foundation
www.fiafoundation.org



UK Department of Transport, Think! Campaign
think.direct.gov.uk



Youth for Road Safety
www.youthforroadsafety.org



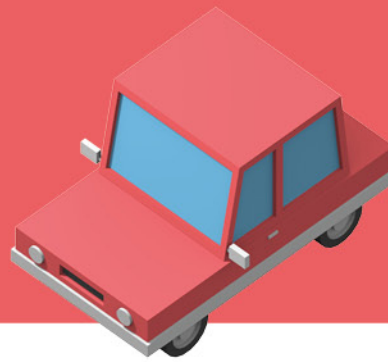
European Bank
 for Reconstruction and Development



Eastern Alliance for Safe
 and Sustainable Transport



FOUNDATION



Road Safety Education Pack

Welcome to the EASST Education Pack. This pack is designed to help teach road safety in a variety of formal and informal education settings.

By using the simple, fun, educational activities, teachers and parents can help young people stay safe on the roads.

This pack provides the resources you need to teach children and young people basic road safety principles in an age-appropriate way.

The key principles underlying all the activities in this pack are:

- **Awareness** of traffic and its dangers.
- **Good behaviour** around roads.
- **Making safe choices** to keep you and others safe.

Why Teach Road Safety?

On average more than 500 under 18's die on the world's roads each day. Road crashes are the biggest killer of young people in every world region.

Road safety is vital for children and young people. It is never too early to teach them about basic safety skills. More than 1.2 million people die on the world's roads every year and tens of millions of people are injured or disabled.

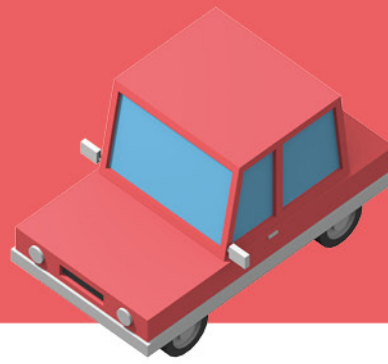
Children are particularly at risk because:

- They are smaller so find it harder to see, and be seen by, drivers.
- They are less able to recognise dangerous situations and lack the maturity to make good decisions about safe behaviour.
- They are physically smaller and so are more likely to be hurt by an impact.

Educators can protect children by teaching life-saving messages and skills. Making young people aware of the risks and providing them with strategies to remain safe are important parts of their development.

Road Safety is a great subject for engaging children and young people. Even the youngest child will know something about it, because everyone uses roads and road safety impacts everyone.





Road Safety Education Pack (cont.)

Introducing the Education Pack

This pack provides stimulating and engaging activities to introduce road safety messages and behaviours.

The pack is split into three sections:

- Under 6s
- 6 – 11 year olds
- 12– 14 year olds

The topics in each section vary according to the target age group, but they all relate to our key principles.

How to Use the Education Pack

Each section of the pack provides age-appropriate resources, along with introductory notes and advice for teachers and group leaders.

These background notes and resources give all the information you need to run road safety sessions with young people.

The resources consist of a mixture of teacher-led ACTIVITIES (lesson plans and exercises), as well as HANDOUTS designed to be copied and given to the children.

The activities and handouts form a road safety education programme that can be incorporated into lessons or after-school activities. We suggest having different activities each week over a number of weeks, and reinforcing road safety messages whenever possible.

The activities and handouts can be used individually, too, to raise specific road safety issues. Each one is a stand-alone exercise for improving safety awareness.

When using these resources, please remember the following points:

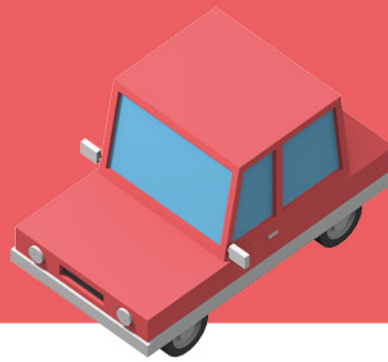
Key Messages

The Teachers' notes for each section outline the **key messages** for the age group. Each exercise also includes key message and objectives. Try to reinforce these key messages at all times.

Active Learning

Children and young people learn best when active and engaged. Try to make your sessions as **interactive** and hands-on as possible.





Road Safety Education Pack (cont.)

Real Life Experience

It is essential for children and young people to learn about roads, traffic and safe behaviour at first hand. Always try to include **outdoor practical activities** in your road safety teaching.

Understanding the Vocabulary

For children to engage fully and understand road safety, they need to be familiar with the relevant **vocabulary**. Make sure the young people you are working with understand the terms you are using. This is particularly important with young children but remains relevant for all age groups.

Diversity

This pack is designed to focus on universally applicable road safety messages and behaviours to keep children safe. However, the children in your group may have **different experiences** of roads and traffic and you may need to adapt your activities accordingly. For example, some children will come from homes where there is no car, or they might live on a street with no pavement. In addition, children in urban and rural areas will face different issues, and their sessions may require a different emphasis.

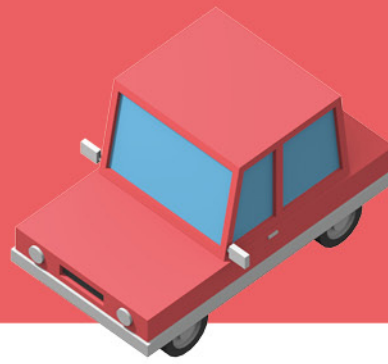
Sensitivities

Group leaders should always check whether there is any child in the group with a family member or friend that has been involved in a serious traffic incident. Special sensitivity will need to be shown in these cases, and it may be appropriate to pre-warn the child's parent or carer so they are able to prepare the child for the activities.

Involving Parents / Carers

In addition to teaching the children, it is vital to include and involve parents with your road safety teaching. Children will be influenced by the behaviour of their parents. This pack includes a letter you can give to parents that makes them aware of what the children have learned and how they can reinforce these messages.





6 -11 year old – Introductory Notes

This section of the pack teaches the following key messages:

Stop, Look and Listen before crossing the road.

Always wear a seat belt.

Be Bright – so that drivers can see you.

Always behave safely in a car.

This section of the pack introduces basic road safety messages to children between 6 and 11 years old. It focuses on awareness of the dangers of traffic, introducing young children to the issues and helping them explore the ideas raised.

Children mature significantly between age 6 and 11, and trainers may need to adapt their sessions depending on the age of the children taking part.

Experts suggest that children under 8 struggle with judging speed and distance and are still developing eyesight and hearing. In addition they tend to be easily distracted and act on impulse. Therefore you may want to integrate some of the activities from the Under 6s pack if you have a group at the younger end of this age range.

Younger children can also be encouraged to think about safe choices, but at this age they should not be making choices on their own. When focusing on the Stop, Look and Listen message, you should remind younger children that they should always be with an adult when crossing a road.

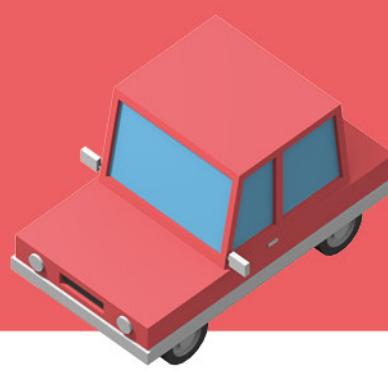
It is essential for children to learn about roads, traffic and safe behaviour at first hand, and the final activity in this section involves taking children on a walk around the local community. Always remember that good planning, close supervision and risk assessment are essential when taking young children near traffic.

Getting Started

The first two activities in this section introduce broad road safety themes to the children and get them to consider their experiences around roads and their ability to recognise hazards.

ACTIVITY: ‘Identifying Hazards’ is a teacher led discussion activity. You will need to take a selection of photos of the local area. Use them to prompt a wide-ranging discussion about a number of road safety issues.





6 -11 year old – Introductory Notes (Cont.)

ACTIVITY: ‘Hands-Up Survey’ This activity builds on the ‘Identifying Hazards’ discussion by reflecting on the children’s own behaviour around roads.

Stop, Look and Listen

This section introduces the ‘Stop, Look and Listen’ message for safe road crossing.

HANDOUT: ‘Stop, Look and Listen’. This is a one-page summary of the five stages of crossing the road. It should be used alongside the other resources in this section.

ACTIVITY: ‘Crossing the Road Safely - Role Play’. This activity is designed to get children to learn the rules of crossing the road in a safe environment.

Once the children have had a chance to look at the handout and take part in the role play, there are a number of exercises to reinforce the ‘Stop, Look and Listen’ message:

ACTIVITY: ‘The Walk Safer Game’ is a fun and active way to consolidate the message.

HANDOUT: ‘Stop, Look and Listen Exercise’ is a worksheet to get the children to focus on the key stages of road crossing.

HANDOUT: ‘Design a Poster’ gets children to focus on the importance of sharing the message with others and uses their creativity.

HANDOUT: ‘Always Hold Hands when Crossing the Road’ is a colouring sheet for the younger children to remind them that they should always be with an adult when crossing the road.

ACTIVITY: ‘Going for a Walk: Putting it All into Practice’. It is important that children get to practice the skills they have learned on real roads. This activity gives you a chance to take the children out for a walk after completing the ‘Stop, Look and Listen exercises.

Always Wear a Seat Belt

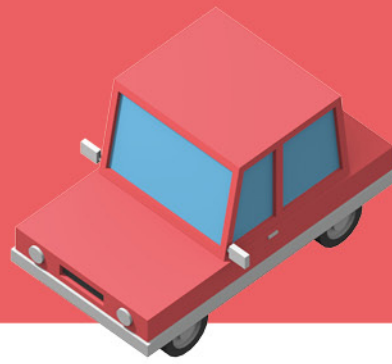
HANDOUT: ‘Alisha’s story’ is a story and range of follow up exercises to teach children the importance of wearing seat belts and the consequences of not doing so.

ACTIVITY: ‘Seat Belt Survey’ is a simple activity to get children to think about the use of seat belts and provides an opportunity to discuss the issues around using them.

Be Bright – So That Drivers Can See You

ACTIVITY: ‘Bright is Right’ is a story to read to the children to introduce this issue. The follow up exercises will help you have a structured discussion around the topic.





6 -11 year old – Introductory Notes (Cont.)

HANDOUT: 'Colour me Bright' is a colouring exercise to reinforce the message.

Always Behave Safely in a Car

HANDOUT: 'In Car Safety Story'. This worksheet introduces the key messages about safe behaviour in cars and gets children to write their own story.

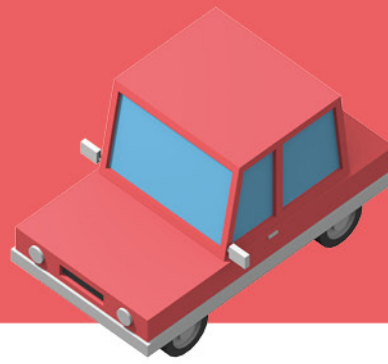
HANDOUT: 'Safe Behaviour in Cars' is a worksheet to get children to consider what behaviour is safe or unsafe.

HANDOUT: 'Spot the Difference'. This is a fun worksheet that pulls together many of the messages throughout the pack. The children need to spot the five differences between the two pictures. The differences in the second picture are:

1. There is a fence and the ball is not heading for the road.
2. The driver is wearing a seat belt and is not waving out of the window.
3. The girl is holding hands.
4. There are leaves on the bush.
5. The mother has a shopping bag.
6. The kerb has been added at the edge of the road.

Remember to reinforce the key messages at all times and to make all your sessions as interactive as possible.





ACTIVITY: Identifying Hazards

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: Up to 45 minutes.

Key Messages: How to recognise hazards and Stop, Look and Listen.

Objective: To get children to recognise hazards, types of traffic, safe and unsafe areas and understand how to use this information to keep safe. It is also an opportunity to discuss issues around crossing roads and the importance of 'Stop, Look and Listen'.

Before starting the activity, take some photos of the local area. Take a variety of pictures to use as the basis of a discussion about hazards, safe places to cross the road, different types of traffic, signs and, if relevant, crossings. The photos should be of places the children will be familiar with and should provide you with a range of scenarios to discuss.

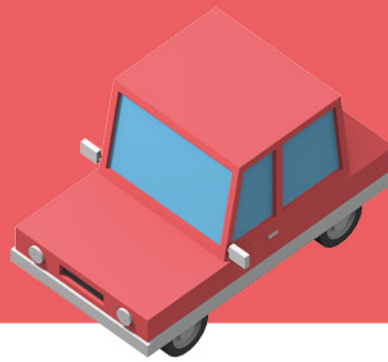
Use the photos to prompt a discussion. Encourage the children to identify hazards and to consider the dangers on the road. Ask the children the following questions:

- Where would be the safest place to cross this road? Why?
- Where would it be dangerous to cross the road? Why?
- What dangers can you see?
- What road signs can you see? What do they mean?
- How many different types of traffic can you see?
- Are there any people? If so, is their behaviour safe or unsafe?
- Are there any vehicles? What are they doing which is safe? Unsafe?
- Might there be hazards you cannot see? Around corners or behind traffic?

Ask the children to relate their answers to real-life situations and to explain how they will put what they have learned into practice.

Get the children to focus on safe places to cross and reinforce the 'Stop, Look and Listen' message.





ACTIVITY: Hands-Up Survey¹

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Messages: Understanding hazards and how to make safe choices around roads.

Objective: A survey to get children to consider road safety conditions and ways that they can enhance their own safety.

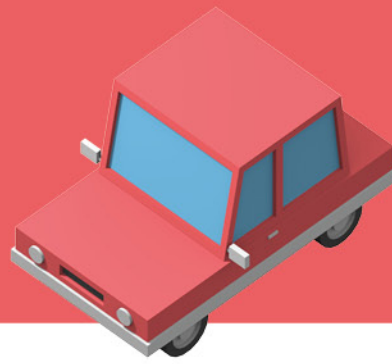
This is designed to be a group activity. The group leader should discuss the local road conditions with the children. The survey is an opportunity for the children to express their views on the issues and a way to get them to think about how to keep safe.

The questions should be asked to all the children. The children should raise their hands to answer 'yes' or 'no'. The group leader should make a note of the answers.

Questions	Yes	No
Do you think local roads can be dangerous for young people?		
When walking locally, do you worry you might be hurt by traffic?		
Have you ever been hit or nearly hit by a vehicle?		
Should the route between your home and school be made safer?		
Do you think the traffic on local roads sometimes goes too fast?		
Have you ever been in a car with a driver who has gone too fast?		
Have you seen drivers using their phones in the local area?		
Have you ever been in a car with a driver who was using their phone?		

¹ This activity is adapted from a resource originally published by Brake, the road safety charity, and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. www.brake.org.uk and www.roadsafetyweek.org





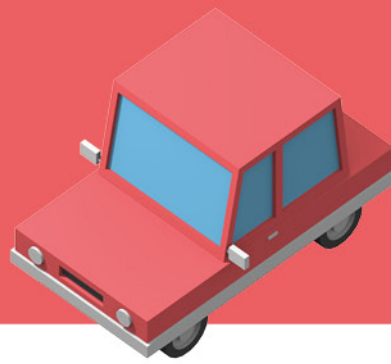
Hands-Up Survey (Cont.)

Once the children have answered the questions, get them to reflect on their answers and the issues raised.

Areas you might like to explore include:

- What are roads like around school and home?
- Are there any safety features to help protect people? Should there be more?
- Where are the most dangerous spots for pedestrians?
- When is it hardest for drivers to see you?
- What could you do to be safer?
- What could drivers do to protect you?

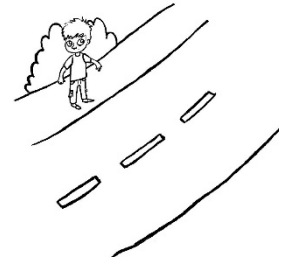




HANDOUT: Stop, Look and Listen

Find the safest place to cross

Find a place where you can see in all directions, and where drivers can see you. Never cross on a bend in the road.



Stop

Stop just before you get to the kerb.
Do not get too close to the traffic.

Look

Give yourself lots of time to have a good look all around for traffic.

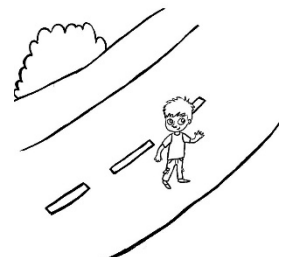


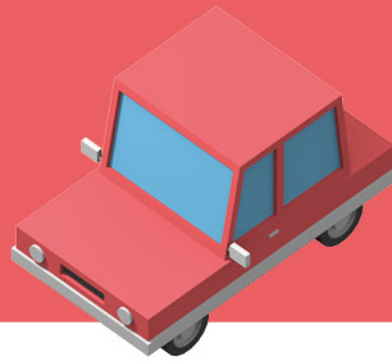
Listen

Listen carefully because you can sometimes hear traffic before you can see it.

When it is safe, cross

Cross when there is a safe gap and plenty of time.
Keep looking and listening while you cross.





ACTIVITY: Crossing the Road Safely - Role Play²

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children. You may wish to use the 'Stop Look and Listen' handout with this exercise.

Time Needed: Around 30 minutes.

Key Messages: Safe behaviour around roads and 'Stop, Look and Listen'.

Objective: This is a role play activity based on the 'Stop, Look and Listen' message. It aims to get children to practise crossing roads in a safe environment.

The aim of this activity is to get the children to take part in a role play exercise where they go on a journey and act out crossing the road in different ways.

Conduct this activity in a hall or classroom. Use coloured tape or chalk to mark out a road and pavement on the floor – and get the children to think about the hazards there might be in a real life situation.

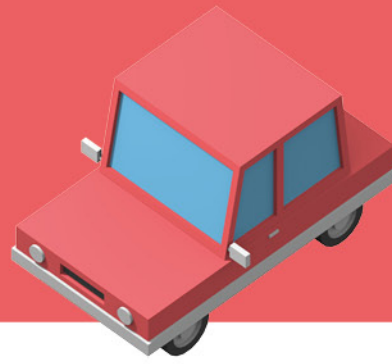
Before you start make sure the children are familiar with the five stages of 'Stop, Look and Listen':

- Find the safest place to cross.
- Stop: Stop at edge of the kerb or road.
- Look: Give yourself lots of time to have a good look all around.
- Listen: Listen carefully. You can sometimes hear traffic before you can see it.
- When it is safe, cross. Look and listen as you cross.

Ask the children in pairs to act out crossing the road whilst holding hands. Make sure they demonstrate all five stages.

² This activity is adapted from a resource originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





ACTIVITY: The Walk Safer Game³

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 15 minutes.

Key Messages: Safe behaviour around roads and 'Stop, Look and Listen'.

Objective: Use this activity to reinforce the messages that you have discussed in earlier activities.

This is an action game. You will need to teach the children a set of actions they must do when instructions are called out in a random order. Children need to spread out in a hall or room. The instructions and actions are as follows:

- Single file! [All get in a line one behind the other]
- Hold hands! [Hold hands with nearest person]
- Use the pavement! [Go to the side of the room indicated]
- Stop, look and listen! [Stand still, quietly, looking all around, ready to cross]
- Walk across! [Walk as if crossing a road, looking all around]

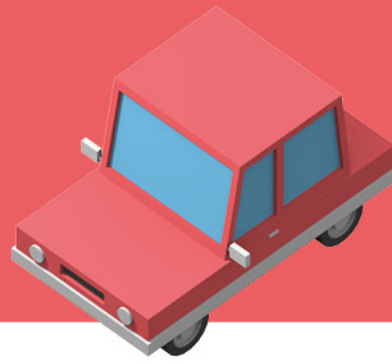
To play the game, show the children the actions and let them practise each one. Then start to call out the instructions in random order. The idea is not to be the last child to do the action (but in this case no one is out).

Start slowly and speed up as the children get more familiar with the actions.

Finish the game by letting children rest and asking them questions such as why they need to walk in single file on narrow country lanes and why it is important to hold hands near roads.

³ This activity is adapted from a resource originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>



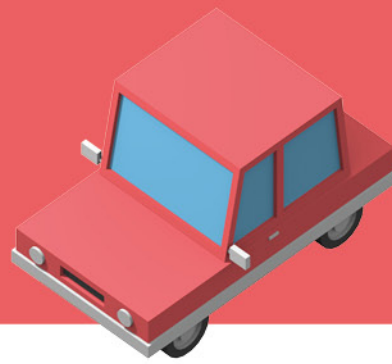


HANDOUT: Stop, Look and Listen Exercise

Below are the five stages of crossing the road. Put them in the correct order.

Listen: Listen carefully. You can sometimes hear traffic before you can see it.	1st
Stop: Stop at the edge of the kerb or road.	2nd
When it is safe, cross. Look and listen as you cross.	3rd
Find the safest place to cross.	4th
Look: Give yourself lots of time to have a good look all around.	5th



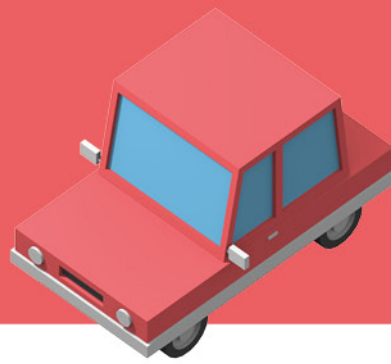


HANDOUT: Design a Poster

Design a poster to remind other children to 'Stop, Look and Listen'.

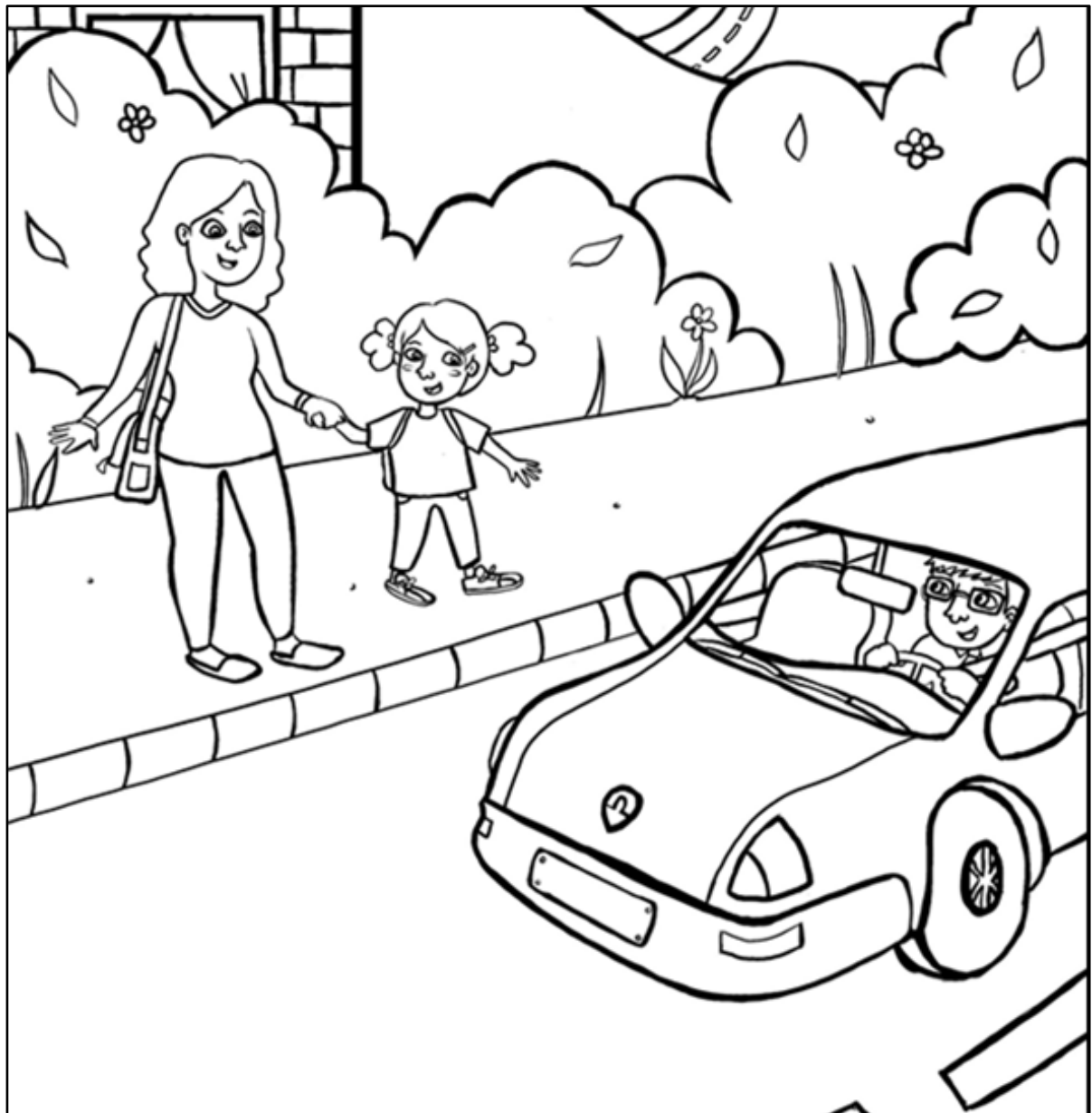
14





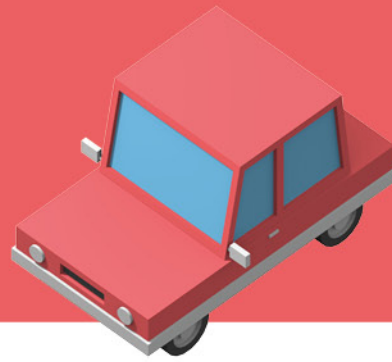
HANDOUT: Always Hold Hands when Crossing Roads

Colour the picture below. Remember always hold hands with an adult when near a road.



15





ACTIVITY: Going for a Walk - Putting it all into Practice

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: Around 1 hour.

Key Messages: Safe behaviour around roads and 'Stop, Look and Listen'.

Objective: To get the children to put the road safety lessons they have learned into practice by going out in the local community and practise crossing roads. You should make sure that all the children are familiar with the 'Stop, Look and Listen' message before setting out.

This activity involves taking the children in small groups for a short walk to enable them to get real-life experience of crossing roads and recognising hazards.

Planning the Walk

Ask the children to suggest a destination and a route. Make sure the route includes two or three opportunities to cross a road.

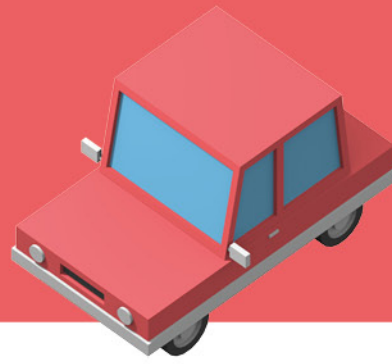
Before setting off, talk to the children about what they think they will see and the hazards they might encounter. Ask the children to consider the following questions:

- Which hazards could cause harm?
- What can they do to keep safe?
- Who can help the children to be safe while they are out and about?

Get the children to create some rules for the walk. These might include:

- Stay with an adult and hold hands with a partner.
- Stay away from the edge of the road.
- Wait at the kerb until it is safe to cross.
- Always Stop, Look and Listen.





ACTIVITY: Going for a Walk: Putting it all into Practice (Cont.)

The Walk

Remind the children of the route and their rules for keeping safe. Divide the children into pairs and head out.

On the walk, make sure you have an adult at the front and back of the group.

Ask the children to look around them and to describe what they can see: Traffic? Parked cars? Junctions? Crossings? Trees? Road signs? Is the road curved or straight? Is the traffic moving quickly or slowly?

When you are ready to cross the road, get the children to suggest a safe place to cross. Ask them to describe the scene and the hazards. Make sure the children wait for a safe gap in the traffic before crossing the road.

When crossing the road, make sure they follow the five stages:

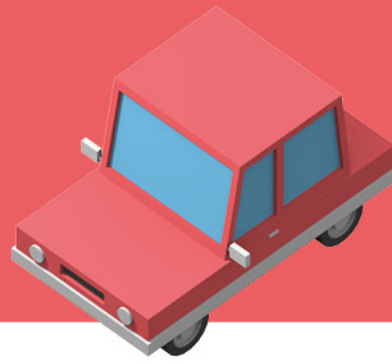
- Find the safest place to cross.
- Stop: Stop at the edge of the kerb or road.
- Look: Give yourself lots of time to have a good look all around.
- Listen: Listen carefully. You can sometimes hear traffic before you can see it.
- When it is safe, cross. Look and listen as you cross.

After the Walk

Ask the children to reflect on the walk and consider the following questions:

- What did they see and hear?
- What helped them to stay safe?
- What hazards did they come across?
- Can they remember the rules for staying safe when crossing the road?





HANDOUT: Story time - Alisha's Story⁴

If I was a bird I could go anywhere ... like when I close my eyes. Way up high in a blue, blue sky. Far, far away in warm, beautiful sunshine. Dancing on air to the lake.

This is the worst time. If I listen really hard I can hear my friends. They will be going to school. Lucky things. I wish I was. I wish I could go out in the sunshine. Just to watch the others play. I can hear them after school and when they are running around. Laughing.

When I feel sad I practise my flute. Music makes me happy. I can't hold it up at the moment or take deep breaths. I'm too sore... It's just not fair. I hate it.

I can't stop thinking about what happened. We all went to the lake. It was going to be brilliant.

It was so sunny. So hot in the car. So hot. Heavy, sweaty seatbelt... Can you see that? That's the lake! And...? I'm going to splash in the water. Cool, cool water. Feel the wind in my hair. Nearly there. Yaaay! Car park! Everybody out! "Not yet!" says Mummy.

Undo seatbelt – too hot – want to see better... Yaaay; I can see.

Scary. I shot right out of my seat and banged my head.

All I know is that my arm aches a lot and my chest really hurts when I breathe. Apparently, I've pulled a muscle or two. Mummy was ok... and the others were frightened but ok. They had their seatbelts to save them. The cars were only going slowly but I was so scared.

When I asked him, Daddy said 'Yes the car will take lots of money to fix. No, not millions... but a lot of money'.

The other car was looking for a space too but the lady was going the wrong way... I'm not allowed to see my friends now because we all get too excited. They came a couple of times but they made me laugh a lot and that makes my chest really hurt.

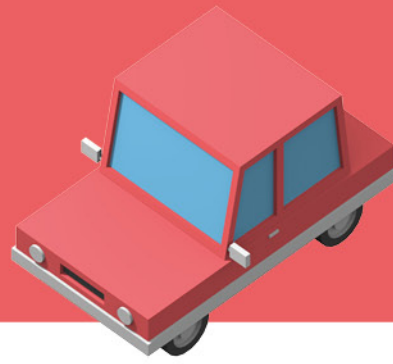
I was lucky. It could have been a lot worse. But my chest hurts and I can't hold my flute because my arm is so sore... I can't do anything I want to. I won't see the lake again. Not for a long time anyway.

If I was a bird I could fly away and never be lonely again. All I did was take off my seatbelt. Stupid, stupid me. It's just not fair.



⁴ This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





ACTIVITY: Alisha's Story - Follow up Exercises

1. What did you learn from the story?

2. How did it make you feel?

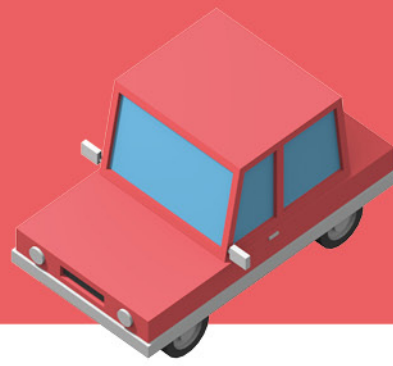
Radio Interview

Alisha was visited by the local radio station who interviewed her about the collision. Can you imagine what Alisha might say and write her answers below?

Reporter: Hello Alisha, can you tell us a little bit about yourself?

Reporter: Now, you were recently hurt in a road collision. Can you tell me what happened?



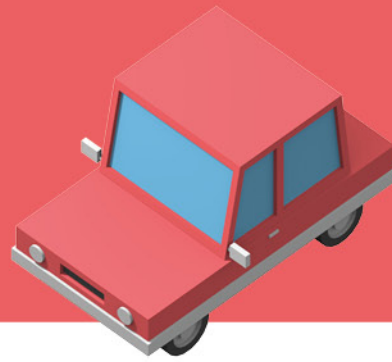


ACTIVITY: Alisha’s Story - Follow up Exercises

Reporter: Well, I can see that you have to stay in bed for some time because of your injuries. How else has this collision affected you?

Reporter: What advice can you give to other children about being safer in cars?





ACTIVITY: Seat Belt Survey

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 1 hour.

Key Messages: Safe behaviour around roads and always wear a seat belt.

Objective: To get children to understand the importance of wearing a seat belt and how they can adapt their own behaviour to make themselves safer.

This activity involves taking the children in a small group to a local road junction to observe seat belt use.

Choose a road or junction where there is a safe place for the children to stand and a steady flow of traffic.

Ask the children to think about what they want to survey and draw up a tally sheet before they set off. Talk to them about what they might see and suggest they might look for:

- Drivers not wearing seat belts
- Front seat passengers not wearing seat belts
- Back seat passengers not wearing seat belts.

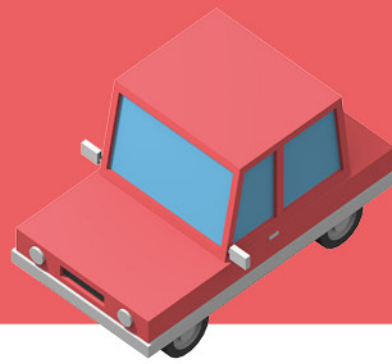
Before setting off, make sure the children understand the rules for staying safe and remain with an adult at all times.

After the Survey

Once the children have completed their survey, bring them together to discuss their findings and to reflect on what they saw. They might want to consider:

- Were drivers wearing seat belts? What percentage or numbers?
- Were front seat passengers wearing seat belts? What percentage or numbers?
- Were back seat passengers wearing seat belts? What percentage or numbers?

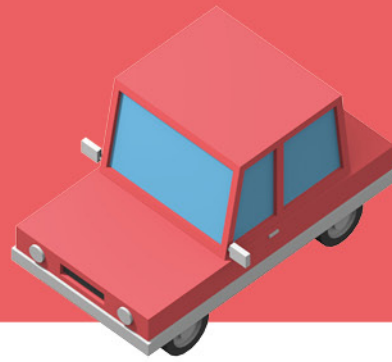




Seat Belt Survey (Cont.)

- Did the children spot any trends when doing the survey? Different behaviour between young and old? Men and women? Adults and children?
- Can the children explain why you should wear a seat belt?
- Do they always wear a seat belt? Has their view changed?
- How can they encourage friends and family to wear a seat belt?





ACTIVITY – Story time: Bright is Right⁵

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the children.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Message: Be Bright – so that drivers can see you.

Objective: To read the story to the children and discuss the issues raised in the Follow Up activities.

It was the day before the party at Amy's friend's house.

Amy was excited. 'Dad, can I wear my new black party dress? And can we walk there?'

'Well, now that you're four I think that's OK,' said her dad. 'It is not far, just down the road'

'Whoopee!' Amy danced about. She loved her new dress.

The next evening was the night of the party. She put on her black dress and black shoes.

'You look very smart' said Dad. 'But you have to wear your reflective armband.'

He held up two white bands. 'But that will spoil my outfit' said Amy, pulling a face. 'It's not smart.'

'But it will keep you safe,' said dad. 'It helps drivers to see you at night.'

Dad put on his band and Amy did too, but she wished she could make it disappear. It was very dark outside and cold. Amy was excited but she held on to her dad's hand.

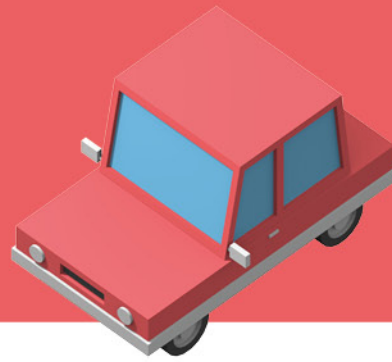
Amy heard some children laughing up ahead. It was hard to see in the dark but they sounded like her friends, Sam and Peter. Then she saw them. They were dressed in smart trousers and dark coats. Amy called to them and they waited for her on the pavement.

Suddenly, dad shouted, 'Watch out!'

A car was reversing out of a driveway towards Sam and Peter. Their mum saw it just in time and pulled the boys out of the way.

⁵ This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





Bright is Right (Cont.)

The car driver stopped. 'You nearly hit us,' said the boys' mum. She sounded cross.

'I'm really sorry, I just didn't see you,' said the driver. 'You're all wearing black.'

Amy looked at her dad and they walked very quietly to the party.

The next day was nursery. Amy got dressed in her brightest clothes and put on her coat with the bright yellow stripe on it.

'You're very colourful,' said dad.

'I want to make sure that drivers can see me' said Amy.

'Clever girl,' said dad. 'Day or night, bright is right!'



Follow Up Exercises

Once you have read the story to the children, discuss the following questions:

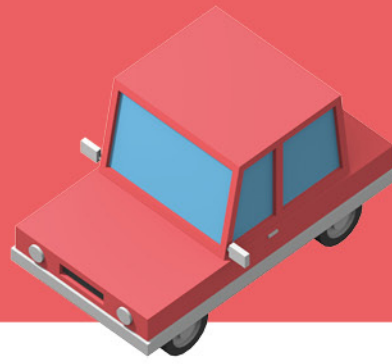
- Why was Amy dressed in black?
- Where was she going?
- What happened to Peter and Sam?
- Why did the car nearly hit them?
- Why did Amy wear bright clothes the next day?

Talk to the children about the clothes they are wearing now.

Who is wearing bright clothes? Who is wearing dark clothes?

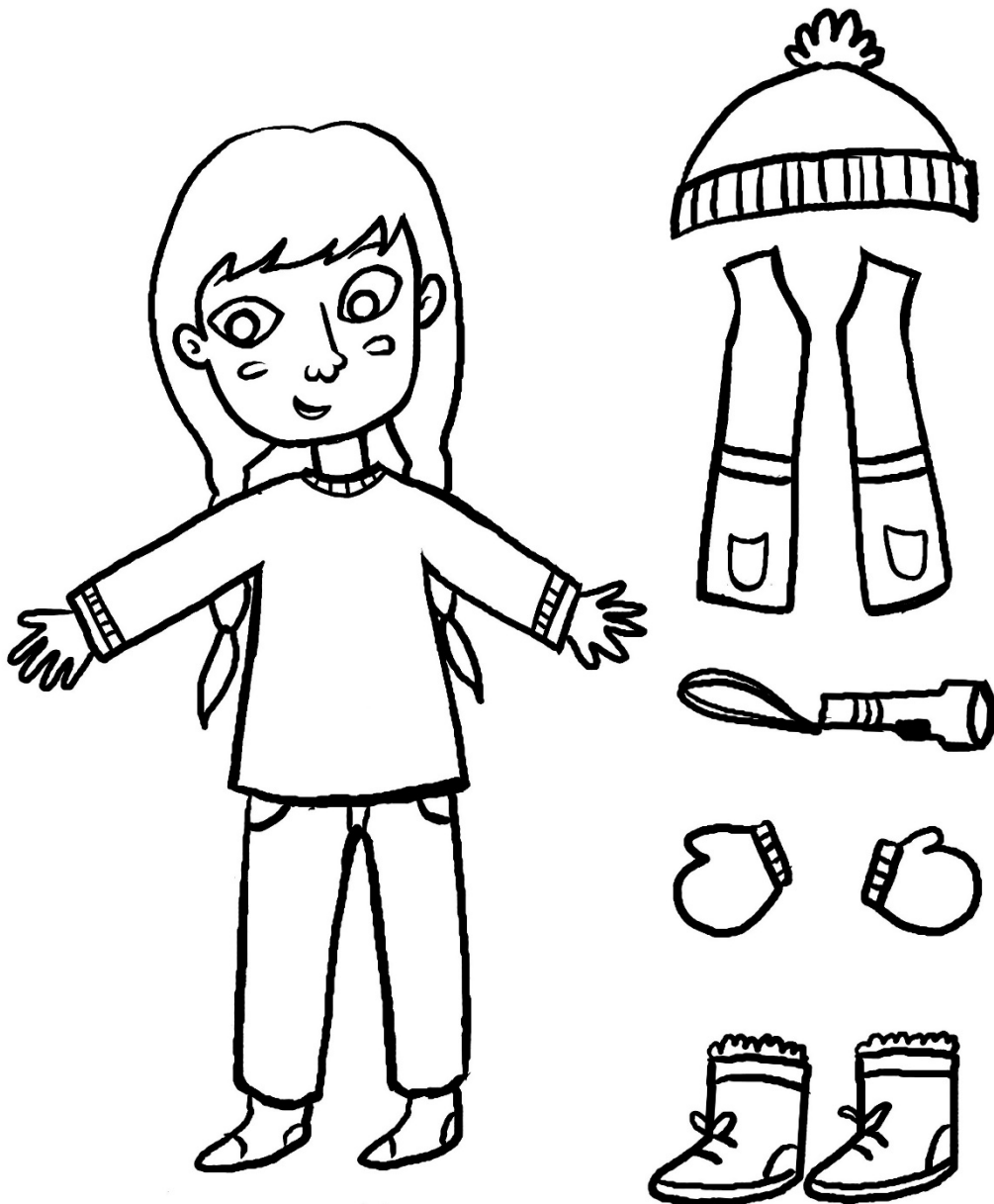
Talk about how bright clothes can help drivers to see you when you are near traffic and how it can keep children safe. Which child would it be easiest for a driver to see?

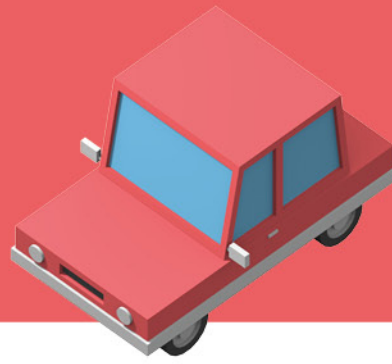




HANDOUT: Colour Me Bright

Colour the clothes in bright colours so that will be easy for drivers to see. Then cut the clothes out and stick them on the girl so she will be safe when out and about.





HANDOUT: In Car Safety Story⁶

Below are six key rules about how to behave when in a car.

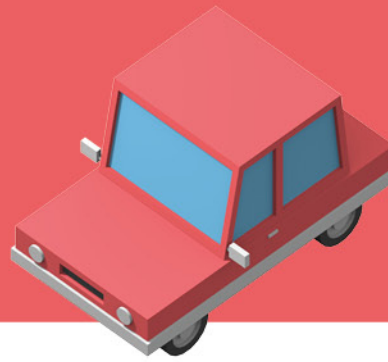
- Always wear a seat belt
- Never lean or wave out of the window
- Do not block the driver's view in the mirror
- When you get in or out, use the door on the side furthest from the traffic
- Do not touch the door handle when the car is moving
- Do not distract the driver

Choose one of these rules and create a short road safety story about it. Think of a story that involves a car journey where a child nearly gets hurt.

Draw a series of pictures with captions to tell your story. There should be a clear safety message at the end.

⁶ This activity is adapted from a resource originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





HANDOUT: Safe behaviour in cars⁷

When travelling in cars it is important to behave correctly to keep safe and to prevent accidents.

- Always wear a seat belt
- Never lean or wave out of the window
- Do not block the driver's view in the mirror
- When you get in or out, use the door on the side furthest from the traffic
- Do not touch the door handle when the car is moving
- Do not distract the driver

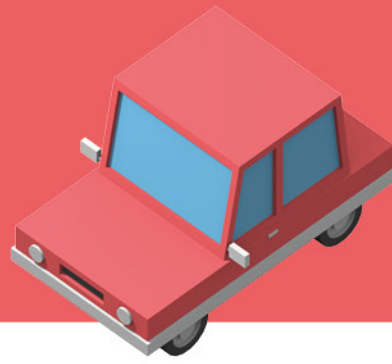
Look at the pictures below and decide if the behaviour shown is safe or unsafe.

	Is this behaviour safe or unsafe? Why? If unsafe, how could it be made safer?
	Is this behaviour safe or unsafe? Why? If unsafe, how could it be made safer?

27

⁷ This activity is adapted from a resource originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>

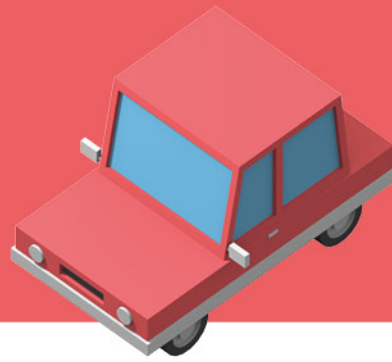




Safe behaviour in cars (cont.)

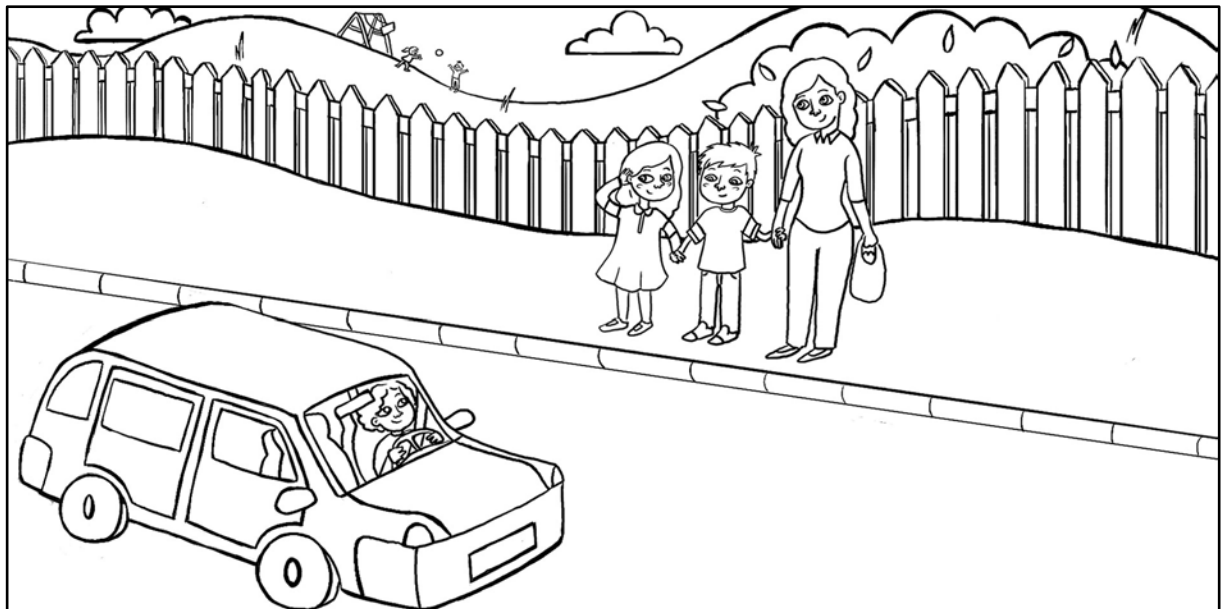
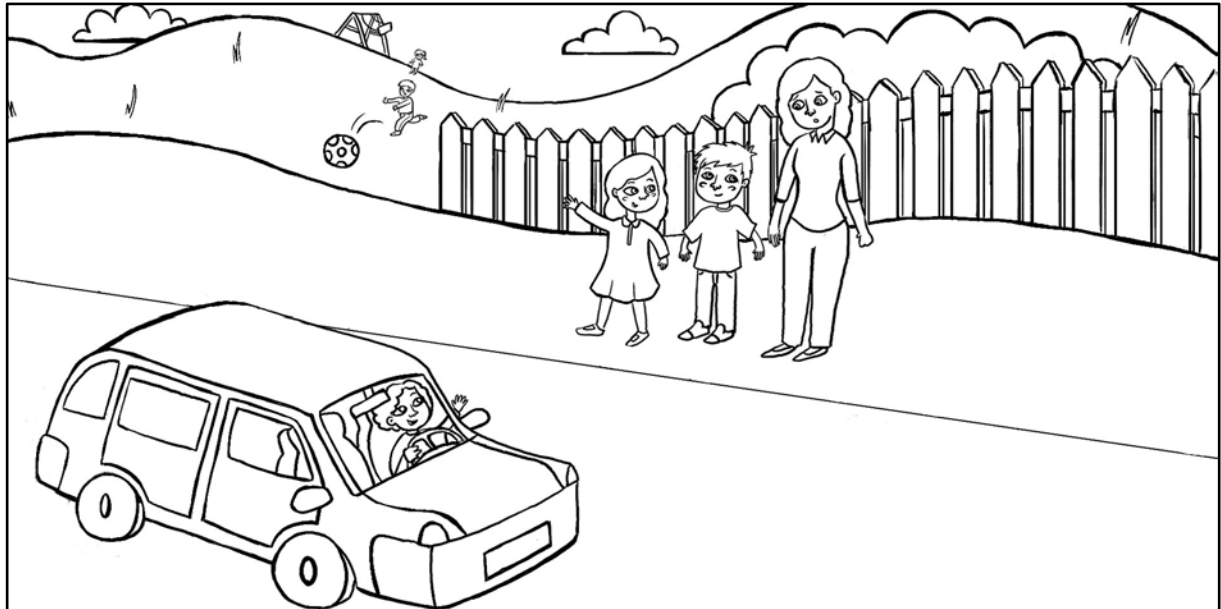
	Is this behaviour safe or unsafe? Why? If unsafe, how could it be made safer?
	Is this behaviour safe or unsafe? Why? If unsafe, how could it be made safer?
	Is this behaviour safe or unsafe? Why? If unsafe, how could it be made safer?
	Is this behaviour safe or unsafe? Why? If unsafe, how could it be made safer?



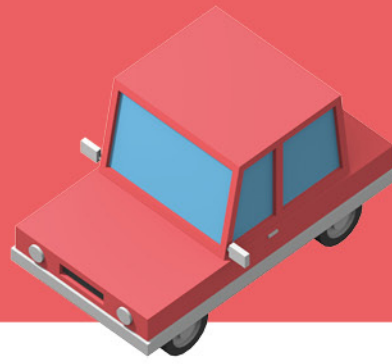


HANDOUT: Spot the Difference

Can you spot the six differences between these two pictures?



ROAD SAFETY EDUCATION PACK



6-11

Dear Parent

Your child has been learning about road safety as part of a project to reduce the number of road casualties.

The children have been taking part in a range of activities including games, creative tasks, storytelling and practical exercises.

These activities have been teaching them how to keep safe around roads and have focused on the following messages:

Stop, Look and Listen before crossing the road.

Be Bright – so that drivers can see you.

Always behave safely in a car.

Always wear a seat belt.

Please talk to your child about what they have been doing today. I am sure they will be keen to tell you about what they have learned.

Children learn best from practical experience, so you can play a vital role in keeping them safe by talking about these issues whenever you are out and about. Please do emphasise these road safety messages at every opportunity. As a parent you are an important role model for your child.

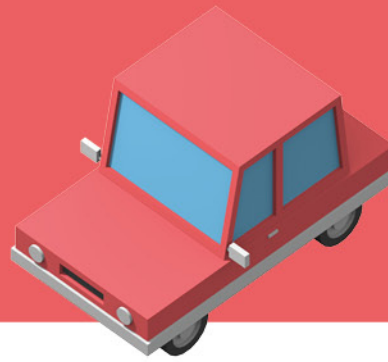
In addition, setting a good example for young children through your own behaviour on the road and in the car will help them learn good safety skills and apply them throughout their lives. Please keep yourself and your children safe by reinforcing the messages we have been learning today.

Thank you for your support and keep safe!

[Insert name / organisation]



ROAD SAFETY EDUCATION PACK



6-11

Acknowledgements

The Eastern Alliance of Safe and Sustainable Transport are grateful to the following organisations for supporting the development of this pack.



Brake, The Road Safety Charity
www.brake.org.uk and www.roadsafetyweek.org



European Bank
for Reconstruction and Development

The European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
www.ebrd.com



FOUNDATION

FIA Foundation
www.fiafoundation.org



UK Department of Transport, Think! Campaign
think.direct.gov.uk



Youth for Road Safety
www.youthforroadsafety.org

31



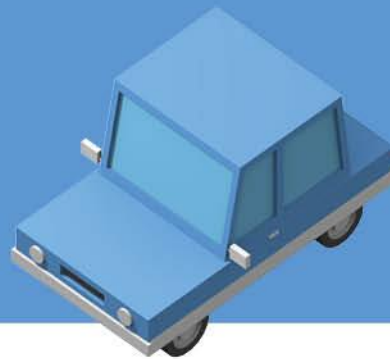
European Bank
for Reconstruction and Development



Eastern Alliance for Safe
and Sustainable Transport



FOUNDATION



Road Safety Education Pack

Welcome to the EASST Education Pack. This pack is designed to help teach road safety in a variety of formal and informal education settings.

By using the simple, fun, educational activities, teachers and parents can help young people stay safe on the roads.

This pack provides the resources you need to teach children and young people basic road safety principles in an age-appropriate way.

The key principles underlying all the activities in this pack are:

- **Awareness** of traffic and its dangers.
- **Good behaviour** around roads and the rules to follow.
- **Making safe choices** to keep you and others safe.

Why Teach Road Safety?

On average more than 500 under 18s die on the world's roads each day. Road crashes are the biggest killer of young people in every world region.

Road safety is vital for children and young people. It is never too early to teach them about basic safety skills. More than 1.2 million people die on the world's roads every year and tens of millions of people are injured or disabled.

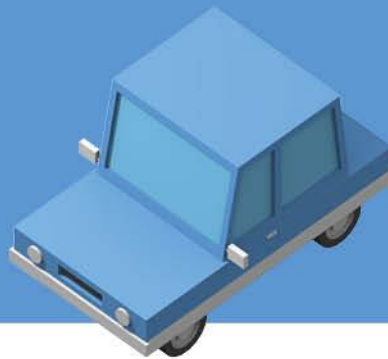
Children are particularly at risk because:

- They are smaller so find it harder to see, and be seen by, drivers.
- They are less able to recognise dangerous situations and lack the maturity to make good decisions about safe behaviour.
- They are physically smaller and so are more likely to be hurt by an impact.

Educators can protect children by teaching life-saving messages and skills. Making young people aware of the risks and providing them with strategies to remain safe are important parts of their development.

Road Safety is a great subject for engaging children and young people. Even the youngest child will know something about it, because everyone uses roads and road safety impacts on everyone.





Road Safety Education Pack (cont.)

Introducing the Education Pack

This pack provides stimulating and engaging activities to introduce road safety messages and behaviours.

The pack is split into three sections:

- Under 6s
- 6 – 11 year olds
- 12 – 14 year olds

The topics covered in each section vary according to the target age group, but they all relate to our key principles.

How to Use the Education Pack

Each section of the pack provides age-appropriate resources, along with introductory notes and advice for teachers and group leaders.

These background notes and resources give all the information you need to run road safety sessions with young people.

The resources consist of a mixture of teacher-led ACTIVITIES (lesson plans and exercises), as well as HANDOUTS designed to be copied and given to the children.

The activities and handouts form a road safety education programme that can be incorporated into lessons or after-school activities. We suggest having different activities each week over a number of weeks, and reinforcing road safety messages whenever possible.

The activities and handouts can be used individually, too, to raise specific road safety issues. Each one is a stand-alone exercise for improving road safety awareness.

When using the resources please remember the following points:

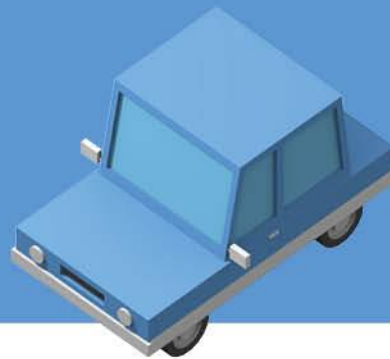
Key Messages

The Teachers' notes for each section outline the **key messages** for the age group. Each exercise also includes key messages and the objectives. Try to reinforce these key messages at all times.

Active Learning

Children and young people learn best when active and engaged. Try to make your sessions as **interactive** and hands-on as possible.





Road Safety Education Pack (cont.)

Real Life Experience

It is essential for children and young people to learn about roads, traffic and safe behaviour at first hand. Always try to include **outdoor practical activities** in your road safety teaching.

Understanding the Vocabulary

For children to engage fully and understand road safety, they need to be familiar with the relevant **vocabulary**. Make sure the young people you are working with understand the terms you are using. This is particularly important with young children but remains relevant for all age groups.

Diversity

This pack is designed to focus on universally applicable road safety messages and behaviours to keep children safe. However, the children in your group may have **different experiences** of roads and traffic and you may need to adapt your activities accordingly. For example, some children will come from homes where there is no car, or they might live on a street with no pavement. In addition, children in urban and rural areas will face different issues, and their sessions may require a different emphasis.

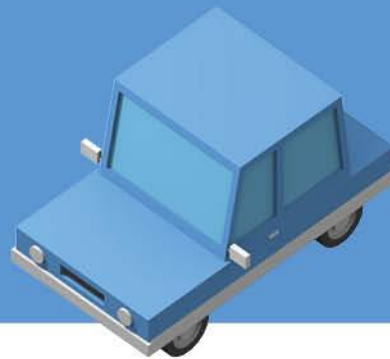
Sensitivities

Group leaders should always check whether there is any child in the group with a family member or friend that has been involved in a serious traffic incident. Special sensitivity will need to be shown in these cases, and it may be appropriate to pre-warn the child's parent or carer so they are able to prepare the child for the activities.

Involving Parents / Carers

In addition to teaching the children, it is vital to include and involve parents with your road safety teaching. Children will be influenced by the behaviour of their parents. This pack includes a letter that you can give to parents that makes them aware of what the children have learned and how they can reinforce the messages.





12-14 year old – Introductory Notes

This section of the pack teaches the following key messages:

Be alert and always look for hazards.

Don't take risks around roads.

Road safety is for everyone.

Avoid peer pressure.

Always wear a seat belt.

This section of the pack teaches road safety to young people aged between 12 and 14. This age group can be hard to engage, as they will already know a lot about basic safety messages and may feel road safety is an issue just for younger children.

However, this is a vital age group to target. Young teenagers have more independence than younger children and are in one of the highest risk groups for dying or being seriously injured on roads. Road traffic injuries are the leading cause of death for 10-24 year olds.

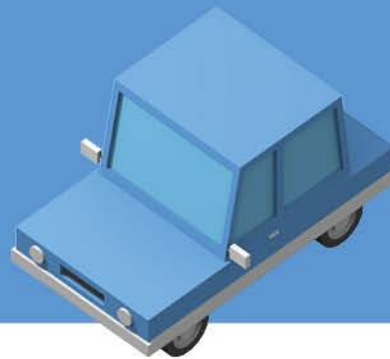
The risks change at this age for several reasons. Teenagers are more likely to test the boundaries than younger age groups, and less able to assess risk than adults. In addition, they are likely to overestimate their abilities and be influenced to take risk by their peers.

When working with this age group, you should be clear that road safety is about stopping deaths and serious injuries and it is crucial to take it seriously.

You should also make sure that your sessions are pitched at the right level and that the teaching:

- Recognises what the young people already know and builds on this knowledge.
- Encourages discussion and participation.
- Relates to the young people's lives and own experiences.
- Involves real-life projects and practical assignments.
- Discusses the dangers of risk-taking and peer pressure and how to make safe choices.
- Gets young people to think about the consequences of their actions.





12-14 year old – Introductory Notes (Cont.)

Getting Started

Hazard Awareness and Understanding Risk

The first couple of activities and handouts in this pack are designed to get the young people to focus on risk. These exercises challenge young people to consider their own behaviour and think about acceptable and unacceptable risk.

ACTIVITY: ‘Risky Behaviour – Group Discussion’ is an activity to get young people to reflect on their own behaviour and challenge their views on risk.

ACTIVITY: ‘How Risky? Activity’ continues this theme and gets young people to discuss and consider levels of risk.

HANDOUT: ‘Journey Planner’ and **HANDOUT: ‘Rate your Safety’** are worksheets designed to get young people to relate their discussions on risk to their everyday experience and apply what they have learned practically.

Road Safety is for Everyone

ACTIVITY: ‘Road Safety Campaign’ is an activity for young people to use their knowledge of safe behaviour around roads and to reinforce basic road safety messages in a non-patronising way.

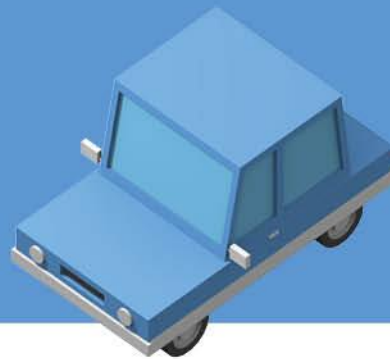
HANDOUT: ‘Have your Say’ is a group discussion exercise to engage young people in thinking about the importance of road safety.

HANDOUT: ‘Cause and Effect’ helps young people to explore the consequences of actions and the effects they have from different perspectives.

Avoiding Peer Pressure

ACTIVITY: ‘Peer Pressure – Drama Activity’. This activity provides an opportunity to use drama to explore peer pressure as well as strategies to deal with it.





12-14 year old – Introductory Notes (Cont.)

Always Wear a Seat Belt

HANDOUT: Seatbelts. This sheet covers many of the key myths about wearing seat belts and challenges them. It can be used as a good overview of the topic.

Driver Behaviour

The next two activities introduce topics relevant to young drivers. It is important to raise awareness of these issues before the young people learn to drive.

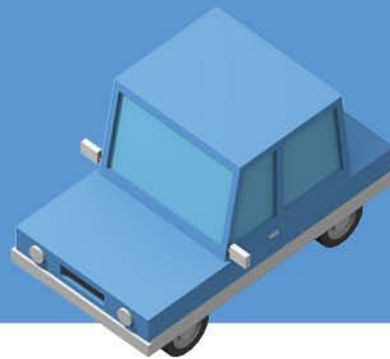
ACTIVITY: 'Driver Behaviour' is an exercise to get young people to research and make short presentations on a range of issues including impaired and distracted driving, wearing seat belts and speeding.

ACTIVITY: 'Safe Driver Survey' is a practical activity to observe driver behaviour first-hand and discuss the issues raised.

Drawing conclusions

ACTIVITY: 'Devise a Pledge Card' is a final activity which gives the young people a chance to draw together what they have learned as well as to pledge to an on-going commitment to road safety.





ACTIVITY: Risky Behaviour – Group Discussion

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the young people.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Messages: Hazard awareness, safe behaviour around roads and the risks to teenagers and young drivers.

Objective: To get young people to recognise that their inexperience and natural tendency towards risky behaviour puts them in particular danger on the roads.

This session is a group discussion to get young people to consider hazardous behaviour around roads and how to behave in order to keep themselves safe.

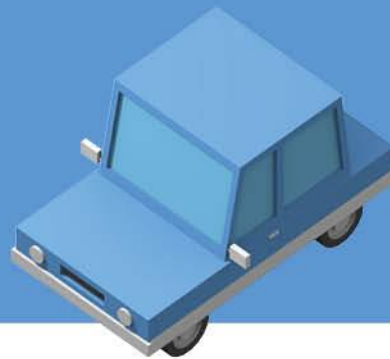
Explain to the group that research shows their inexperience means that they are less able to spot hazards, and their youth means they are especially likely to take risks.

Young people are the group most at risk on the roads - over 30% of those killed and injured in road traffic crashes are under 25. Road traffic injuries are the leading cause of death for 10-24 year olds.

Ask the young people in your group to consider the list below and see if they recognise any of the behaviours or characteristics in themselves or their friends. How might these behaviours put them at risk and how might they modify their actions to keep safe?

- Taking risks around roads – and thinking road safety is only for little children.
- Being over-confident and believing that you don't need to take care.
- Using a mobile phone or wearing headphones when crossing roads.
- Messing around with your friends near roads.
- Not wearing a seat belt when in a car.
- Going out at night without bright clothing – making it hard for drivers to see you.





ACTIVITY: How Risky?

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the young people.

Time Needed: 30 minutes.

Key Messages: Stay alert around roads and behave safely. Don't take unnecessary risks.

Objective: To get young people to consider the level of risk involved in day to day activities and to assess acceptable and unacceptable risk.

Print and cut out several sets of the statements on the next page.

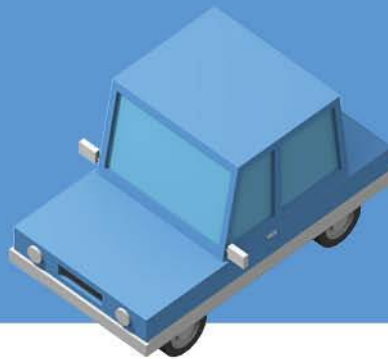
Split the young people into small groups and give each group a set of the statements. Get each group to discuss the scenarios and assess the level of risk involved with each one. After discussion, get them to divide the statements into three piles:

- Low risk – I would do this.
- Could be risky – Not a good idea.
- Very risky – Never do it.

Once all the small groups have assigned the cards to the three piles, bring them back together for a whole-group discussion.

Ask which cards they put in each pile and why? Get them to compare their answers and see if they all agree. If they disagree – ask them to discuss their reasons.





How Risky? (Cont.)

Checking your phone whilst walking along the pavement

Leaving late for school

Going out at night wearing dark clothing

Messing about with friends at the bus stop

Playing football in the park

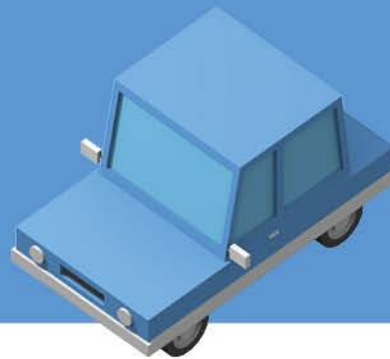
Listening to music through headphones whilst crossing the road

Encouraging a driver to exceed the speed limit

Playing around in the back of a car when getting a lift home

Not wearing a seat belt





HANDOUT: Journey Planner¹

You will travel between your home and school around 400 times a year. This exercise is to help you look again at this journey and consider ways to make it as safe as possible.

Find or draw a local map that shows your journey to school.

Follow the stages below to analyse your journey and use the grid to consider the hazards and ways to reduce the risks.

- List the hazards at each stage (Things that could harm you).
- Rate the risk for each hazard - high, medium or low? (How likely is it to happen?)
- Think about how you could remove or reduce the risk and keep yourself safer.

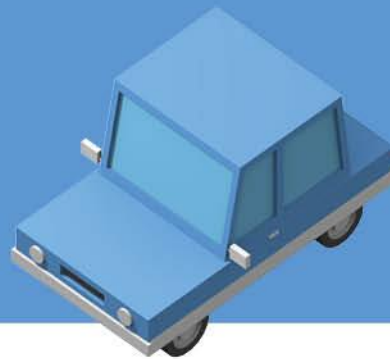
Below is a sample grid. Look at this example and then complete the grid below for your journey.

Stages of my journey	Hazards	Risk	How to make my journey safer
Walk along the lane with no pavement to the main road	Being hit by a vehicle coming along the lane	Medium / high	Walk at the edge of the lane facing the oncoming traffic. Wear bright clothing.
Walk on the pavement along main road to the bus stop	Being hit by a car coming out of the driveway	Medium / low	Stay alert. Do not get distracted by friends or by your phone. Avoid wearing headphones.
Get on the bus	Risk of falling if the bus stops suddenly	Low	Find a seat or hold on to a railing if standing
Get off the bus and cross the road to school	Being hit by a vehicle	Medium	Wait for the bus to pull away. Find a place with good visibility to cross. Stop, look and listen before crossing.

10

¹ This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





HANDOUT: Journey Planner (Cont.)

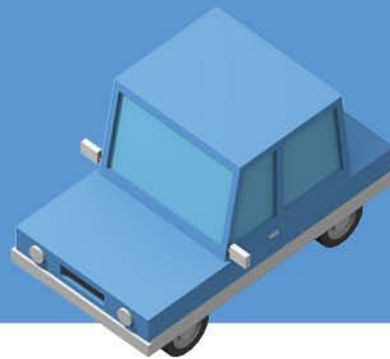
Use this grid to analyse your own journey to school

Stages of my journey	Hazards	Risk	How to make my journey safer

In addition, think about what you might do if something unusual happens?

- What if you are running late and in a rush?
- What if you miss your bus or your lift home?
- What happens if your friends are messing around near the road?





HANDOUT: Rate your safety

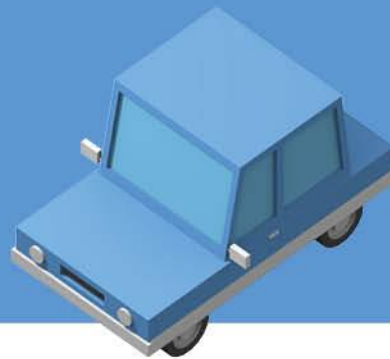
This is an exercise to help you rate your personal safety and assess your behaviour around roads.

Look at the chart below and consider how often you do any of the following:

	Rarely	Regularly	Always
Do you allow enough time for your journey?			
Do you go out at night wearing high visibility clothing?			
Do you wear headphones when crossing the road?			
Do you use your mobile phone near roads?			
Do you cross the road between parked cars?			
Do you cross roads regardless of the traffic?			
Do you run across roads?			
Do you wear your seatbelt when travelling in a car?			

When you have completed the grid, compare your answers with your group and reflect on how you might be able to improve your safety.





ACTIVITY: Road Safety Campaign

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and not designed to be given to the young people.

Time Needed: Minimum of 1 - 2 hours or longer for more ambitious the projects.

Key Messages: Stop, Look and Listen, Young Children should hold hands with an adult, Be bright, Always wear a seat belt.

Objective: To get young people to think about key road safety messages and reinforce them through a real-life project.

Ask the young people to devise a road safety campaign for younger children. Talk to them about the campaign and how they might present it.

Start by getting the young people to consider the message that their campaign will focus on. They might want to choose one of the following:

- Stop, Look and Listen
- Holding hands with an adult
- Be bright
- Always wear a seat belt

Once the young people have decided on their message, get them to work on their own or in small groups to devise the materials for their campaign. They could use a range of mediums including:

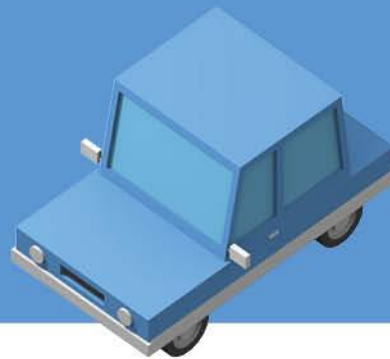
- Posters
- Games or stories
- Leaflets
- Video or social media (depending on the resources available).

Make sure the young people consider how to engage their audience and keep their key message central to their project.

Give them lots of time to devise their materials and provide them with as many resources as you can.

If possible, create links with a primary school or group of young children who could receive the projects when they are completed.





HANDOUT: Have your say²

Below are quotes from young people about their attitudes to road safety.

In small groups, discuss their views. Are they right? Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Adults go on about how dangerous the roads are and how I should always cross at a safe point. But when they cross the road, they do it anywhere. Why should I be bothered about road safety if they aren't?

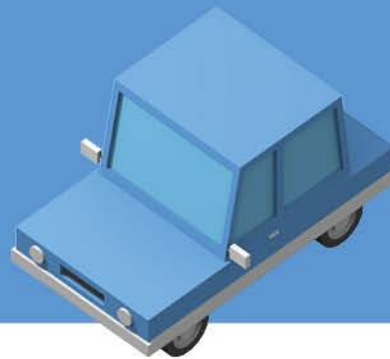
My friends were messing around and running in front of cars. I thought it was stupid but I didn't want to look scared. So I joined in as well. I only did it once.

We did lots about road safety in my primary school. Now it's not that important because I'm not a little kid anymore. Been there, done that. None of my friends has been hurt. I don't think I need to worry about it.

It's impossible to be safe where we live.

² This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





Have your say (Cont.)

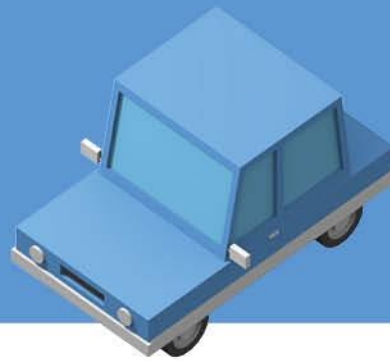
I know what the rules are but you don't always remember them in real life. When I'm late for school, I'm just thinking about getting there in time. I ran out to cross the road the other day and nearly ran into this old guy on a bike. I guess I was lucky.

Road safety? No, that's not something I even think about. It's not in the news on TV or on the radio every day like being stabbed or shot. Those things scare me.

I don't think there's any point worrying about it. I mean if you are going to get run over then it will just happen. It's not like you can do anything to stop it. If you're in the wrong place at the wrong time. Don't you think?

I never used to wear a seat belt in the back. They're too uncomfortable and I am too old for that now anyway. But then I saw this advert about what happens if you don't wear a seat belt and it really made me think. I always wear a seat belt now. Do you think I'm being too careful?





HANDOUT: Cause and Effect³

The text below describes a traffic incident involving a thirteen year old boy called Josh. Read about Josh's accident and then use the information below to consider the accident from the perspective of the different characters involved.

Josh's Accident

It was a Monday morning and a 13 year old boy called Josh was rushing to get to school. He was running late and had received a text from his friend, Ben, saying he was already at school. Ben wanted Josh to get to school as soon as possible so they could play football before class.

Josh saw his bus across the road. He rushed out into the road to get to the bus stop. He was hit by a car driven by a young mother with her baby in the back.

Josh did not see the car and the driver did not have time to stop.

Josh was taken to hospital with leg and head injuries that will take several months to heal.

After the collision, Josh has to spend a lot of time resting. As he started to recover, he had to spend a lot of his free time catching up on homework. He missed the end-of-term school trip and couldn't spend time with his friends.

Read the comments below from the characters involved. Think about how each person might feel, the consequences for each of them and how the accident has affected their lives.

Josh

"I was already late. Then Ben texted to say he was already at school and he wanted a game of football. I saw the bus was about to stop over the road, so I just ran out to get on it. Next thing I know, I'm on the way to hospital. I was out of action for months."

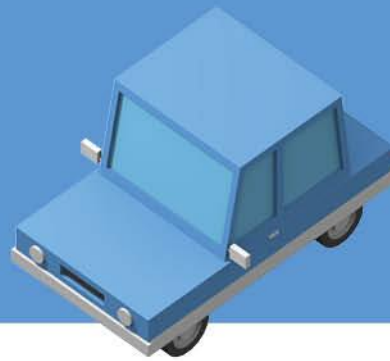
How could the incident affect Josh? Consider:

- Josh's physical injuries
- Things that Josh can't do with his friends while he recovers
- The time he is missing from school
- Josh's confidence when he is using the roads

16

³ This resource was originally published by the UK Department of Transport's Think! Campaign and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. <http://think.direct.gov.uk>





HANDOUT: Cause and Effect (Cont.)

- How the incident could change the way Josh behaves in the future
- Josh's relationships with his friends

Ben

'I was already at school and bored. Josh had promised to be early so we could play football before class. Josh was late. I texted him to tell him to hurry up just before it happened. I really wanted a game. I'm just so happy he wasn't killed.'

How might the incident affect Ben? Consider:

- Whether Ben feels responsible for causing Josh to rush
- How it could change Ben's friendship with Josh
- What Josh's friends think of Ben
- How Ben will change his behaviour in the future

Josh's Mum

'Josh was knocked over when he was rushing to school. I was always telling him to be careful on the roads. He was lucky the car wasn't speeding. He damaged his knee and hit his head so he had to have stitches. He was off school for ages.'

How might the incident affect Josh's Mum? Consider:

- Whether she blames him for the incident
- The things she will allow Josh to do in the future
- How she will treat Josh when he is going out on his own
- How she felt when she got the call to say Josh had been involved in the incident and when she saw Josh in hospital.

The Car Driver

'It was horrible. The boy just ran out in front of me. I couldn't stop. I hit him. I was singing to my baby in the back so maybe I was a bit distracted, but I don't think that caused it. You can never be 100% sure though. I go over it again and again in my head. Good job I was going slowly. I could have killed the lad if I'd been going quicker.'

How might the incident affect the car driver? Consider:

- Whether she feels guilty for being partly to blame for what happened to Josh
- Her confidence in her driving
- The time and cost to get her car repaired
- What her friends and family might think about her and her driving.





Handout: Cause and Effect (Cont.)

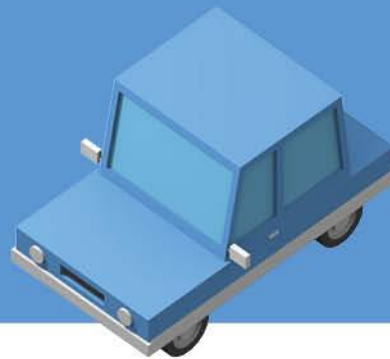
The Police Officer

'I see it all too often with young people on the roads. As pedestrians, on their bikes, in cars. This lad was lucky. A little faster and he'd probably have been killed.'

How might the incident affect the Police Officer? Consider:

- What he thinks of young people as road users
- How he feels when he arrives at the incident
- How he feels when he has to tell Josh's Mum about the incident
- How the incident might influence how he behaves with his own children.





ACTIVITY: Peer Pressure – Drama Activity⁴

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and not designed to be given to the young people.

Time Needed: Around 1 hour – depending on the number of groups.

Key Message: Don't give in to peer pressure.

Objective: To use drama to explore the issue of peer pressure and equip young people with strategies to deal with it.

This exercise involves the young people producing a short piece of drama, approximately three to five minutes long.

If you have a large group of young people, you may wish to split them into groups of around 5 or 6.

Brief the young people that they will need to create a drama that includes evidence of peer pressure related to road safety. The story should include examples of risky or dangerous behaviour and young people being pressured to join in.

Make sure all the young people understand the concept of peer pressure. You may want to discuss examples before they start work on their dramas.

Every story should cover:

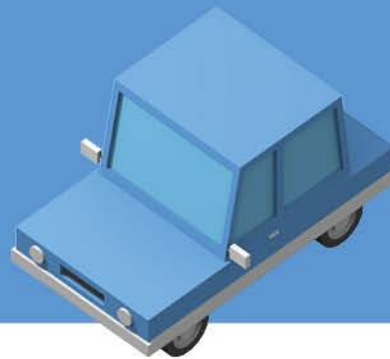
- A key road safety message
- Strategies for handling peer pressure and how to avoid becoming involved in dangerous behaviour
- The consequences of peer pressure

Give the young people 15 – 20 minutes to devise their story and rehearse their plays. During this time the trainer should spend some time going around the groups checking that they are on track with the task.

Once the young people have had time to rehearse – they should perform their short pieces to each other.

⁴ This resource was originally published by the UK West Yorkshire Fire Service and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. www.westyorkshire.gov.uk



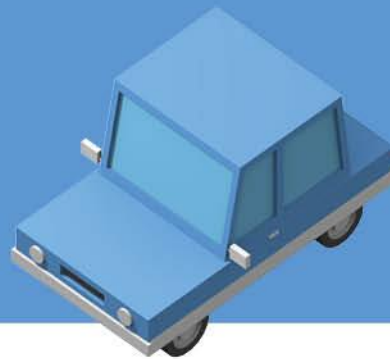


Peer Pressure – Drama Activity (Cont.)

After watching each of the dramas, you may want to discuss the following points:

- What was the risky behaviour that caused the problem?
- What type of peer pressure was evident?
- Were friendships/relationships affected?
- Was there any damage to persons or property? How might these injuries affect each of the characters?
- How could the characters have behaved differently? Could they have changed their behaviour to bring about a better outcome?





HANDOUT: Seatbelts⁵

Seatbelts save lives: the simple action of belting up has saved more lives than any other road safety intervention in history. Still have an excuse not to wear your seatbelt? Here are some common excuses and why they just aren't right.

I'm only going round the corner and I'll drive really slowly.



Most crashes happen within 4 km of home and at speeds less than 60 kph.

Seatbelts are uncomfortable and restraining.



Seatbelts can be uncomfortable to start with but you get used to them.
As for restraining, that's what they are supposed to do!

I'm sitting in the back - only front seat passengers need seatbelts.



Unrestrained passengers in back seats are a threat not only to themselves but to those sitting in the front seats. In a crash, they can be thrown into the front seats or hit other passengers.

If I'm in a crash and the car is on fire or goes underwater, a seatbelt could trap me.



Crashes involving fire or water are less than 1% of all crashes. In crashes like this, without a belt you could be dead or injured before facing the challenges posed by fire or water. You can unbuckle your seatbelt if you need to.

Belts can hurt you in a crash.



Not more than you will be hurt without one. Seatbelts are meant to restrain you in your seat and prevent you from being hurt inside the car or thrown out. 75% of people who are thrown from a car in a crash are killed. Seatbelts rarely cause serious injuries.

21

⁵ This resource was originally published by YOURS / Youth for Road Safety and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. www.youthforroadsafety.org



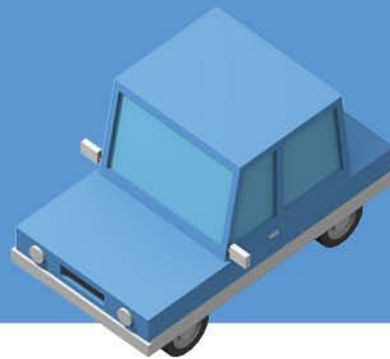
European Bank
for Reconstruction and Development



Eastern Alliance for Safe
and Sustainable Transport



EIA FOUNDATION



ACTIVITY: Driver behaviour

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and not designed to be given to the young people. This activity will require internet access.

Time Needed: Up to 1 hour.

Key Message: Always wear a seat belt. Never use a mobile phone whilst driving. Don't Drink and Drive. Don't speed.

Objective: To get young people to research and understand the issues facing young drivers and to help them to develop positive attitudes before they become drivers.

Split the young people into groups and ask them to research a topic related to driver behaviour. You will need internet access for this exercise. Ask each group to prepare a two-minute presentation on their subject. Ideally you will have four groups to cover the following four topics.

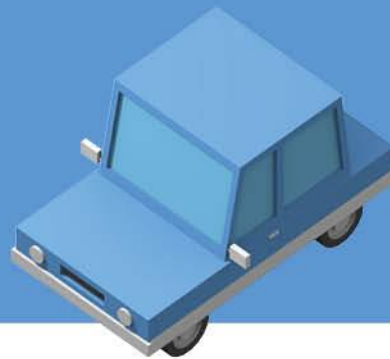
- Impaired driving – alcohol, drugs, tiredness
- Seat belts
- Speeding
- Distracted driving - such as driving while eating or talking on a mobile

They might want to consider the following factors:

- What is the current law in your country? Does it need to be strengthened?
- Road traffic incident statistics
- Road Safety campaigns – either in your country or around the world
- How young people can influence the situation?
- How could driver education be improved in this area?

Once the groups are ready – ask each group to give their presentations to the others.





ACTIVITY: Safe Driver Survey

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and are not designed to be given to the young people.

Time Needed: Around 1 hour for the survey – additional time for the Follow Up activity.

Key Messages: Always wear a seat belt. Never use a mobile phone whilst driving.

Objective: To get the young people to observe the traffic first hand and think about safe and unsafe driver behaviour.

This activity involves taking young people to a local road junction, in small groups, to observe traffic for 20 minutes and to think about safe driver behaviour. This is important as it is crucial that messages about safe driving are taught to young people before they learn to drive.

Choose a road or junction where there is a safe place for young people to stand and where there is a steady flow of traffic.

Before you set off, talk about what you might see and suggest that they look out for some of the following hazardous behaviours:

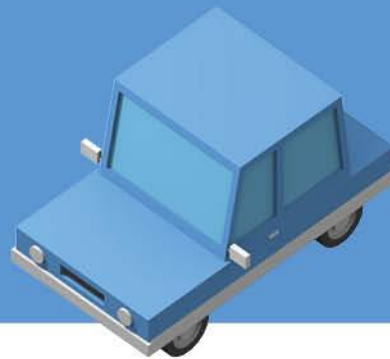
- Drivers not wearing seat belts
- Passengers not wearing seat belts
- Drivers using mobile phones
- Dangerous driving i.e. not stopping at junctions, cars in the wrong lane or speeding

It may be best to focus on one or two issues. The group should devise a tally sheet to record their data whilst carrying out the survey.

After the survey

Bring the group(s) back together and get them to report on their findings. They should analyse their data – for example, what percentage of drivers were / weren't wearing their seat belt? You could get them to present their findings as graphs or charts.



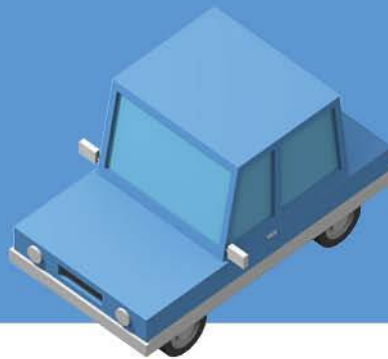


Safe Driver Survey (cont.)

Follow up project

You can follow up this exercise by asking them to devise a campaign to encourage drivers to wear seat belts, or not to use mobiles whilst driving.





ACTIVITY: Devise a Pledge Card⁶

Teacher's Notes: This is a teacher led activity. These notes are for the group leader and not designed to be given to the young people.

Time Needed: 45 minutes.

Key Message: To be decided by the young people.

Objective: To get young people to consider key road safety messages and to understand how their own behaviour can help to keep them safe.

This is a group activity to create a road safety pledge card or poster. The idea is that the whole group discusses and commits to road safety rules and then creates a pledge card to sign.

Let the group come up with its own list of rules or pledges. This should be done through group discussion. Suggest they limit their pledges to between 5 and 8, to challenge them to think about which are the most important issues.

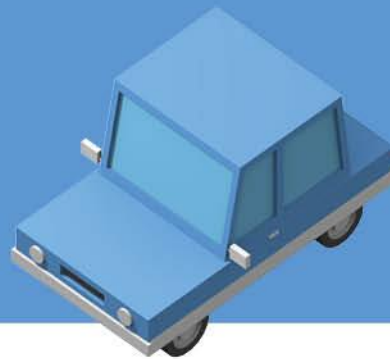
Once the young people have decided their pledges, they should design individual cards to sign, or create a large group poster that they can all sign together.

Below is a sample pledge card.



⁶ This activity is adapted from a resource originally published by YOURS / Youth for Road Safety and we are grateful for their permission to reproduce it. www.youthforroadsafety.org





Dear Parent

Your child has been learning about road safety as part of a project to reduce the number of road casualties.

The young people have been taking part in a range of activities including discussions, creative projects and practical exercises.

These activities have been teaching them how to keep safe around roads and have focused on the following messages:

Be alert and always look for hazards.

Don't take risks around roads.

Road safety is for everyone.

Avoid peer pressure.

Always wear a seat belt.

As young people get older, they have more independence than small children. In addition, teenagers have a tendency to take more risks, overestimate their abilities and be influenced by their peers to push the boundaries of safe behaviour. As a result, this age group is one of those at the highest risk on roads.

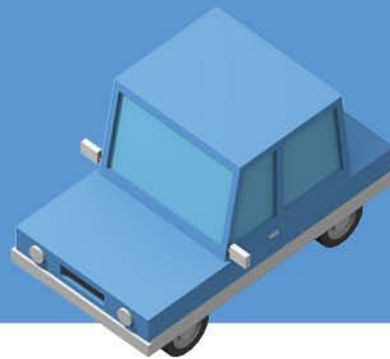
This project gets young people to appreciate the importance of good behaviour around roads, increase their ability to assess hazards and helps them to recognise and resist peer pressure.

As a parent you are a role model for your child. Please reinforce these road safety messages at every opportunity by setting a good example through your own actions. Seeing good behaviour on the road and in the car will help your child learn safety skills and apply these throughout their lives.

Thank you for your support and keep safe!

[Insert name / organisation]





Acknowledgements

The Eastern Alliance of Safe and Sustainable Transport are grateful to the following organisations for supporting the development of this pack.



Brake, The Road Safety Charity
www.brake.org.uk and www.roadsafetyweek.org



European Bank
 for Reconstruction and Development

The European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
www.ebrd.com



FOUNDATION

FIA Foundation
www.fiafoundation.org



UK Department of Transport, Think! Campaign
think.direct.gov.uk



Youth for Road Safety
www.youthforroadsafety.org



European Bank
 for Reconstruction and Development



Eastern Alliance for Safe
 and Sustainable Transport



FOUNDATION